Updated for 2024

How to hit

Google Front Page



A beginner guide to writing blog posts that rank high on Google

Victoria Kurichenko

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INTRODUCTION

Hi dear reader!

Thank you for purchasing my actionable guide on “How to Write Blog Posts That Hit the Google Front Page!”

I am excited to teach you my proven-to-work keyword research and SEO writing processes that will help you create high-ranking content on Google.

As an SEO expert, I’ve written over 50 blog posts for B2B and SaaS companies. In addition, I’ve published roughly 100 optimized blog posts on my website.

In recent years, I’ve tested various on-page optimization techniques, content structures, writing tips, and SEO tools. I try something new almost daily to stay on track with the latest SEO updates and only teach you the tried-and-true strategies that work for me and my clients.

The first chapters of this ebook will share the most important Google algorithm updates of 2023 and how the SEO environment will change in 2024. With this knowledge, you’ll be one step ahead of your competitors.

The core chapters of this ebook will teach you everything you need to know and do to rank in the top 10 organic search results on Google. I’ll explain what happens behind the scenes after you publish content on the web, how to pick easy-to-rank topics for your website, and how to increase your website’s click-through rate (CTR) in organic search results.

You'll also learn what to do if your website rankings drop. Spoiler alert: this strategy has yielded positive results in 100% of cases. I use this strategy whenever I see a continuous decline in impressions, organic traffic, and rankings. So, stay tuned for the chapter five.

My case studies will share invaluable insights about the impact of AI-generated content on SEO. You won't find similar case studies elsewhere because most SEO specialists tell you what you should do without mentioning why and what you can achieve.

If you are just starting your SEO journey, this ebook will help you quickly learn proven-to-work keyword research and SEO writing strategies without the fluff.

If you have decent experience in SEO, this ebook will help you deepen your knowledge of SEO, better understand Google's indexing process, the role of AI in SEO, and so much more!

Before getting started, let me share a few words about my experience in SEO and content writing.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Nice to meet you!

My name is **Victoria Kurichenko.**



I'm an SEO expert, a top writer on Medium, a solopreneur, the founder of Self Made Millennials, and a voracious reader.

I started my SEO career back in 2015 when I transitioned from being a customer support representative to an online reputation manager (ORM). Analyzing my first job in online marketing, I can certainly say the company I worked at back then didn't need an ORM specialist. Nevertheless, they helped me make a significant transition within the company.

I spent four years working on various projects without knowing what I was doing and having a team to mentor me. This was tough. If I could turn back time, I would have made different decisions to save my time and protect my mental health.

Nevertheless, that experience helped me realize what I didn't want to do in my life and how to manage multiple tasks simultaneously.

My real SEO experience started in 2019 when I joined a user experience (UX) design agency. I've learned about UX design, SEO, paid advertisement, and SEO content writing since I have worn all possible marketing hats for three years.

All the accumulated knowledge and experience helped me quit my full-time job, build a personal brand, and work with established product design companies, marketing agencies, and SaaS companies worldwide.

In 2020, I started writing during the pandemic, which has changed how I see and live my life now.

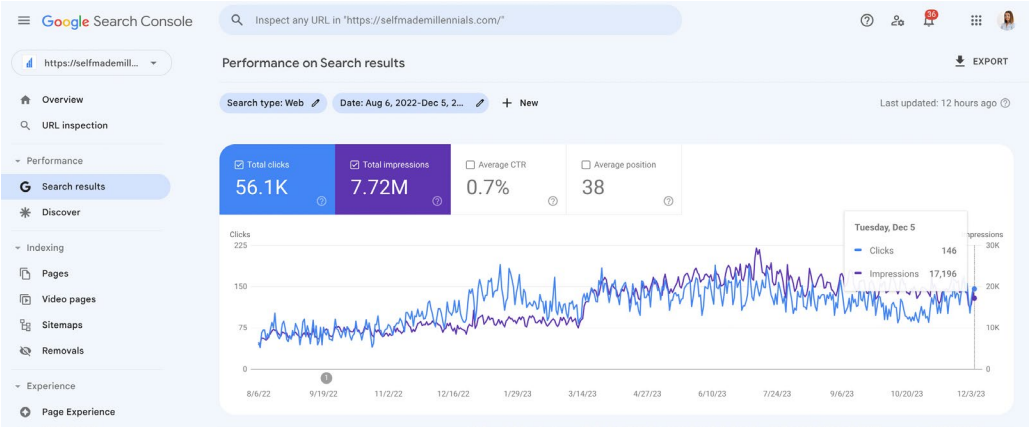
I've published 300+ blog posts on Medium, reaching over 700,000 readers worldwide.

My words helped me get featured in Medium's top publications, such as Better Marketing and Start it Up, the Shapr3D blog, Beehiiv, and more!

In July 2021, I launched selfmademillennials.com as a digital environment for my marketing and SEO experiments.

I've grown Self Made Millennials from 0 to 6,000+ active monthly users while working on my website only a few hours a week. Since I've always had many projects, I couldn't dedicate more time to my website. Nevertheless, my website's traffic has been steadily growing.

Here is the traffic growth chart from my Google Search Console account:



My website impressions and clicks August 6th, 2022 – December 5th, 2023. Source: Google Search Console

Companies I worked at:

LIMEUP Shapr3D uxstudio Digital Commerce Partners

My works are featured in:

The Startup ENTREPRENEUR'S HANDBOOK

BetterMarketing squadhelp beehiiv

Now, I am on a mission to help companies create optimized content and attract potential clients from organic search results.

Like you, I adore blogging and content writing. I am excited to teach you how to grow your website using SEO.

P.S. The ebook contains affiliate links. I might get a small commission if you purchase recommended products.



Chapter 1

EVERYTHING YOU NEED TO KNOW ABOUT GOOGLE'S UPDATES IN 2023

Google has changed a lot in recent years, which means some strategies that SEO specialists and site owners preached no longer work.

Google implements over 10 major algorithm updates yearly. Every time an algorithm update happens, your website can lose or gain rankings. The second is rare, though. I've experienced it several times on my website, but I've also seen a very harsh decline in rankings due to Google algorithm updates.

If you want to be aware of the latest Google algorithm changes, I recommend occasionally checking the Search Status Dashboard. That's the most reliable resource to learn about Google algorithm updates.

In 2023, Google made significant algorithm updates 10 times; that's almost once a month!

Since we observe the same algorithm updates yearly, there is a high chance Google will release them in 2024, too.

Let me explain what every Google algorithm update means for you as a website owner and how you can ensure your website won't be affected.

Google Search Status Dashboard

This page provides status information on the services that are part of Google Search. Check back here to view the current status of the services listed below. If you are experiencing an issue not listed here, please contact Support. Learn more about what's posted on the dashboard in this FAQ. For additional information on these services, please visit https://developers.google.com/search/help/status-dashboard.

Available Service information Service disruption Service outage

All incidents reported for Ranking

2023

SUMMARY	DATE	DURATION
November 2023 reviews update	8 Nov 2023	29 days
November 2023 core update	2 Nov 2023	25 days, 21 hours
October 2023 core update	5 Oct 2023	13 days, 23 hours
Ranking is experiencing an ongoing issue	5 Oct 2023	26 days
October 2023 spam update	4 Oct 2023	15 days, 12 hours
September 2023 helpful content update	14 Sep 2023	13 days, 11 hours
August 2023 core update	22 Aug 2023	16 days, 3 hours
April 2023 reviews update	12 Apr 2023	13 days, 2 hours
March 2023 core update	15 Mar 2023	13 days, 7 hours
February 2023 product reviews update	21 Feb 2023	14 days

2022

SUMMARY	DATE	DURATION
December 2022 link spam update	14 Dec 2022	29 days
December 2022 helpful content update	5 Dec 2022	38 days

1. Google Helpful Content Update

Google has refined its algorithms to better identify and reward websites that provide genuinely helpful content.

Introduced in September 2023 for the first time, the Google Helpful Content update aims to prioritize websites with original, informative, and engaging content that genuinely serves users' needs. This update likely places increased importance on content quality, relevance, and user engagement metrics rather than the number of keywords or backlinks.

This update affects website owners by encouraging them to create high-quality content that is well-structured, easy to read, and provides valuable insights to users.

Gone are those days when you could easily generate content and make it rank in organic search results. Today, Google wants to know who's behind the content and whether the content piece will satisfy users' search intent.

Based on my experience, this is one of the most important algorithm updates to consider when creating optimized content on your website.

I'll teach you how to create content that's in line with Google requirements in the following chapters of this ebook.

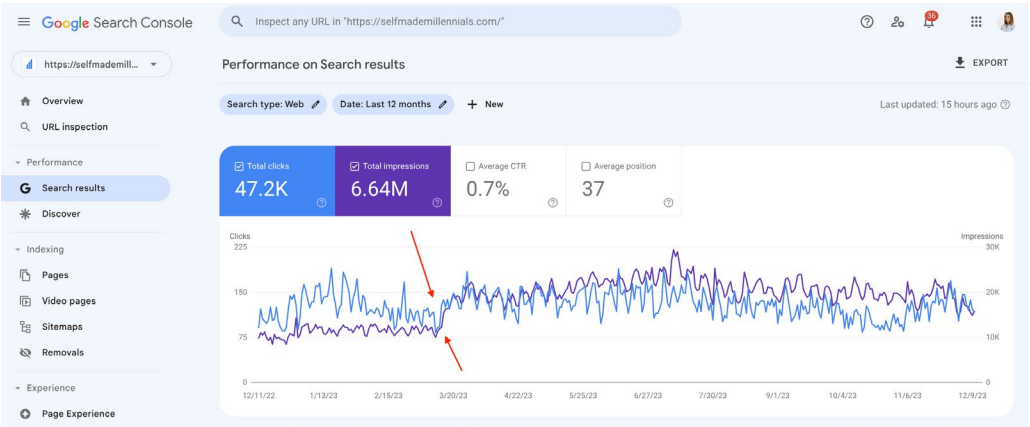
2. Google Core Algorithm Update

Core algorithm updates are significant and can impact search results comprehensively. These updates usually aim to improve the overall search experience, including content quality, technical aspects, and user experience, by refining how Google ranks and displays search results.

Keeping content relevant and user-friendly is crucial to maintaining and improving search rankings.

I recommend updating your money-making pages, disavowing backlinks, and reviewing the overall SEO strategy only if your website lost its rankings considerably due to the core algorithm update!

The screenshot below shows how impressions and clicks on my website changed after the Google March 2023 core update. The drop was insignificant. Therefore, I quickly improved the rankings by implementing the strategies described in chapter five, "What to do if your website rankings drop."



How the March 2023 Core update impacted my website. Source: Google Search Console.

3. Google Review Update

Do you publish and monetize product reviews on your website?

Are you planning to launch a website and write listicles like "Top X Tools for Content Writers in 2024?"

In both cases, your website can be affected by the Google Review update.

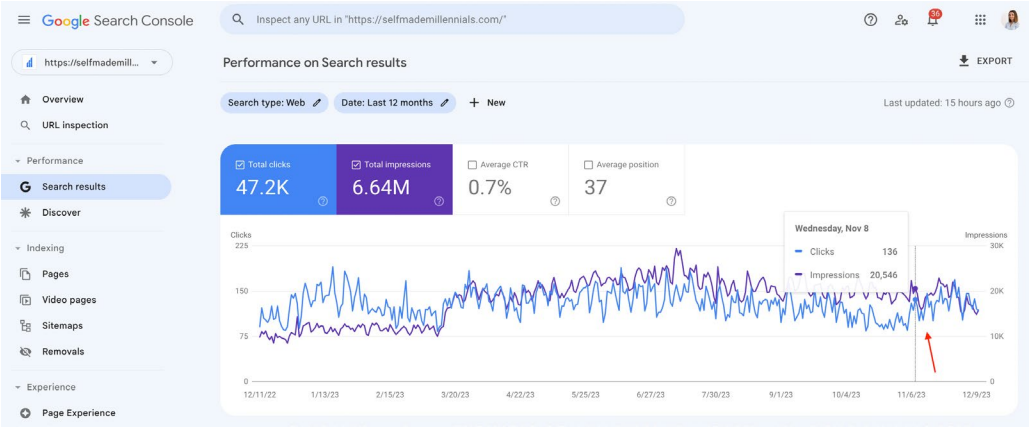
In a nutshell, the Google Review Update was introduced to evaluate the credibility and quality of online reviews.

It focuses on identifying fake or misleading reviews and prioritizing those that are genuine and helpful to users.

This update affects website owners who rely on reviews for their business reputation and search rankings.

If you write and monetize product reviews like me, ensure your review system is robust and transparent. Include product screenshots, videos, how-to guides, and personal stories to help users understand that your product review is authentic.

Here's how the November 2023 Review update impacted my website. Like in the previous example, the impact was relatively insignificant.



How the November 2023 Review update impacted my website. Source: Google Search Console.

You may wonder how to check whether your website was impacted. Here's what you can do.

1. Track Google update announcements on the Search Status Dashboard or the official Google Search Central page on X (former Twitter).

2. Check your website performance daily in Google Search Console. It's a free website performance tracking and analysis tool that provides the most accurate information about your website's performance in organic search results, including indexing, impressions, clicks, and rankings.

If you don't have Google Search Console installed yet, check this how-to guide from Google.

Your website is affected if you notice a significant and continuous drop in impressions, clicks, and rankings in Google Search Console.

No need to panic! It happens to all website owners.

All you need to know is how to create optimized content aligned with Google requirements to avoid your website being penalized by the algorithm updates.

Luckily, you are reading this ebook now, which will help you master the art and science of SEO writing.

Before sharing any actionable strategies, I want to ensure you know what SEO updates and changes you can expect in 2024.



Chapter 2

SEO TRENDS YOU CAN'T IGNORE IN 2024

Many things happen in the SEO world daily. However, not all of them last long.

In this chapter, I want to talk about one trend that's already shaping the world of SEO and will have an even bigger impact on site owners in the following years.

You've probably guessed I'm talking about artificial intelligence (AI) and its impact on SEO.

Here's the challenge.

> **Everyone's using AI tools, like ChatGPT and Bard, to write content nowadays.**

Why should you bother about AI as a site owner?

AI chatbots like ChatGPT or Bard are trained on a massive dataset of existing content and then use this data to generate new content.

I know that content created by ChatGPT and Bard lacks personality and credibility. However, it's only a matter of time before AI will be smart enough to provide accurate answers fast.

What's next?

Here comes another issue — a massive spread of AI-generated content all around the web!

If it takes me 1–2 days to write, optimize, and publish an article on my website, AI can generate hundreds of new content pieces within this time frame.

It’s ridiculous.

One human-written article versus hundreds of AI-generated content pieces.

I’ve also seen some clients slowly shifting towards using ChatGPT for content writing. They say, *“Why hire content writers if ChatGPT can do the same thing but faster and cheaper?”*

Despite being an SEO expert, I could not come up with a proper response to this statement.

Technically, Google is not against using AI:

> *“It's important to recognize that not all use of automation, including AI generation, is spam. Automation has long been used to generate helpful content, such as sports scores, weather forecasts, and transcripts. AI has the ability to power new levels of expression and creativity, and to serve as a critical tool to help people create great content for the web.*
>
> *However, using automation — including AI — to generate content with the primary purpose of manipulating ranking in search results is a violation of our spam policies.”*

Read the last sentence one more time.

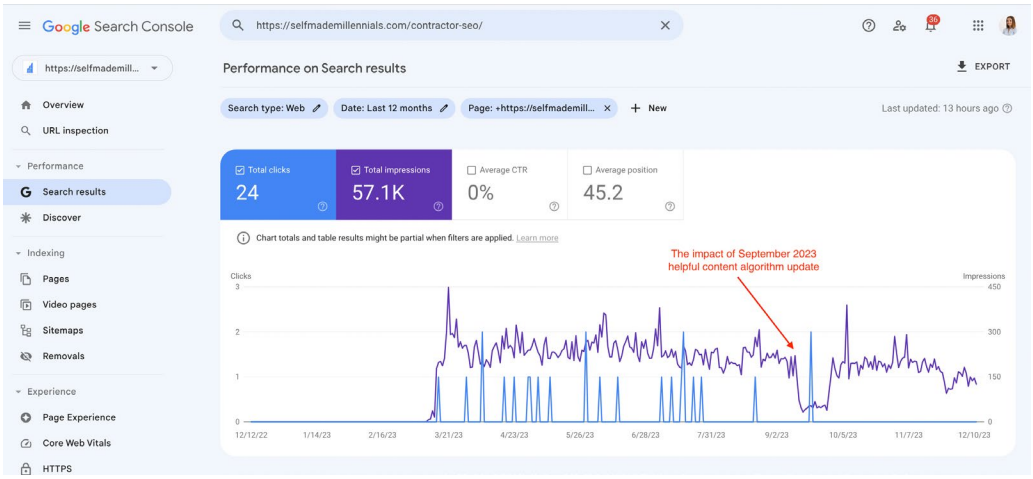
Google explicitly says that using AI-generated content to manipulate rankings is a policy violation. Guess what? That’s the primary reason why site owners use content generation tools.

Before AI content generation became mainstream, I conducted several experiments on my website to measure the impact of AI-generated content on website performance in organic search results. In particular, I wanted to learn if Google treats AI-generated content differently and how it would rank.

Let me share my case study findings.

Here's how an article entirely generated and optimized by ChatGPT performs in organic search results.

When I first published this article on my website in March 2023, I predicted its impressions would eventually fall to 0. I was right. The tendency is negative, and the page is heavily impacted by Google algorithm updates.



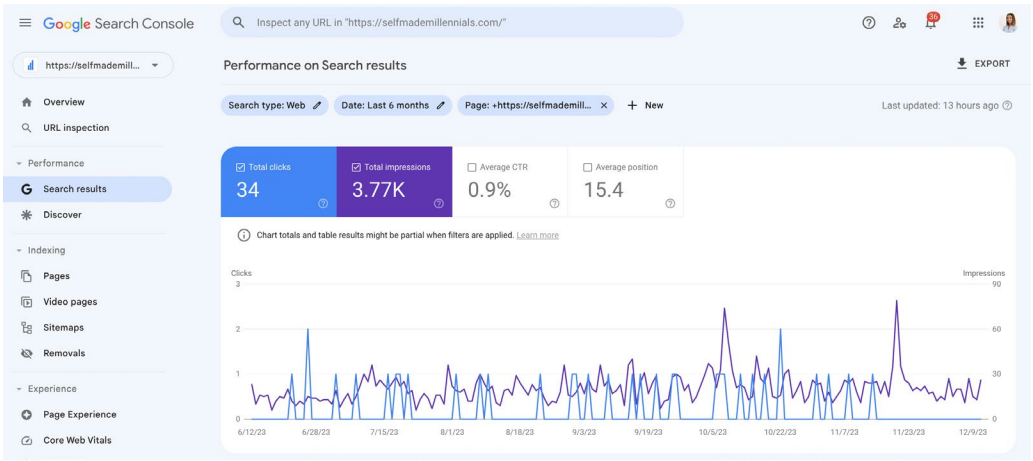
How an article generated with ChatGPT performs on my website. Source: Google Search Console.

Here's another example with a Bard-generated article.

I published this article in June 2023.

I did not build backlinks to this article or use any other means to promote it. I published it to see how it would perform and whether I

could potentially use AI to quickly generate tool reviews. Spoiler alert: no!



How an article generated with Bard performs on my website. Source: Google Search Console.

You might have noticed that the article gets some organic traffic despite low impressions. That's because I targeted a low-competitive keyword. As soon as more website owners publish similar content, this article will lose its position.

I've shown you two examples from my website. However, I've also seen similar cases on my client websites.

My ultimate conclusion is the following:

Publishing AI-generated content on your website is at your own risk! An article that combines AI and human writing, shares value for readers, and expresses author credibility will perform much better.

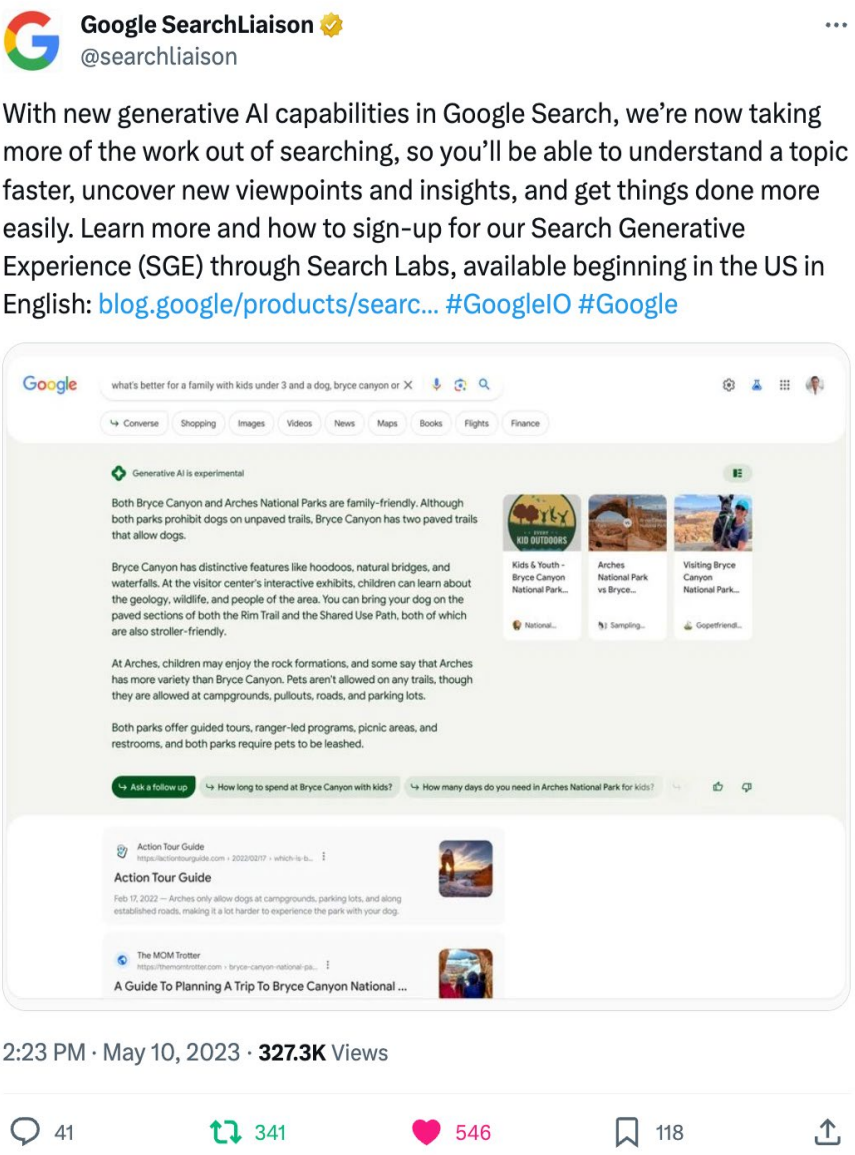
In the following chapters, I'll show you how to effectively leverage AI tools without getting a penalty from Google.

However, let me share a few words about the Generative AI trend first.

Generative AI in SERP

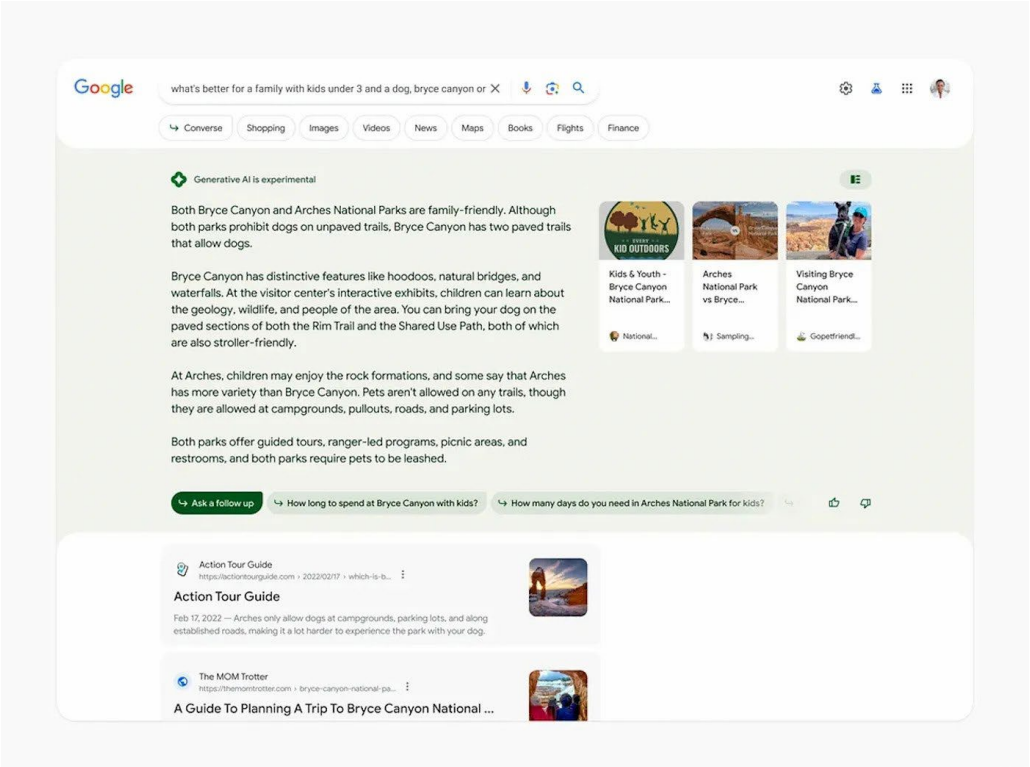
On May 10th, Google announced generative AI integration into the Google search result page (SERP), which made me seriously worry about the future of SEO.

This is their official announcement on X (former Twitter).



Google's announcement of the Generative AI in SERP. Source: X.

Google said that the top of the search engine result page will be occupied by AI-generated snippets like this one:

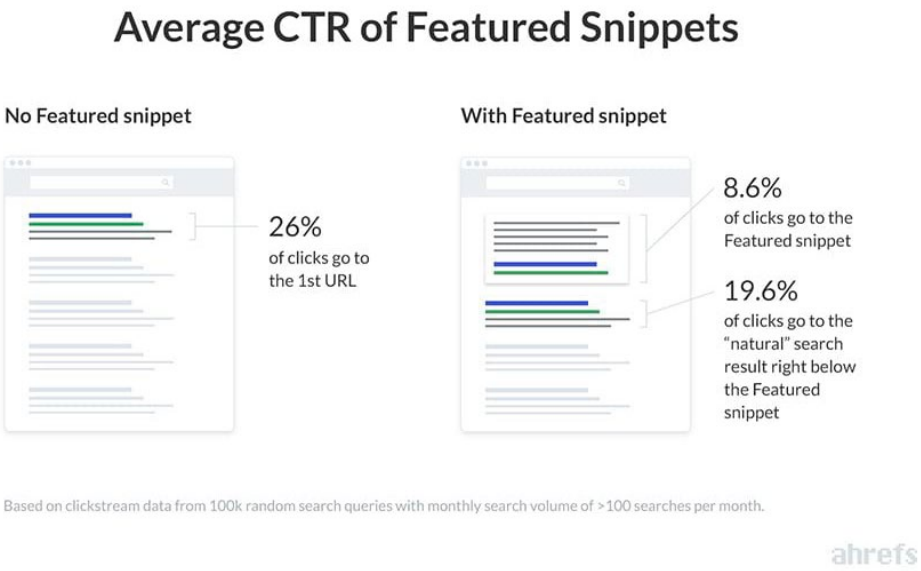


A new type of generative AI snippets for SERP. Source: X.

I hope you get it now why SEO specialists have started to worry.

This giant AI-generated snippet is designed to respond to users' queries, preventing them from navigating to websites.

Instant answers, featured snippets, and zero-click searches have reduced CTR (click-through rate) by roughly 20% for top-ranking websites.



Study of the average click-through rate of featured snippets. Source: Ahrefs.

Can you imagine what will happen after Google releases AI-generated snippets?

I have a few thoughts about it:

1. Drop in the overall click-through rate (CTR) for all top 10 ranking web pages.

2. More fierce competition for the top 3 positions in organic search results.

3. Google can create new ad opportunities to incentivize people to pay for top positions on the search result page.

4. Google's chatbot, Bard, will generate answers to informational queries in search results. It means users won't need to navigate to websites to read more information.

5. Even top-performing websites will see a drop in organic search traffic.

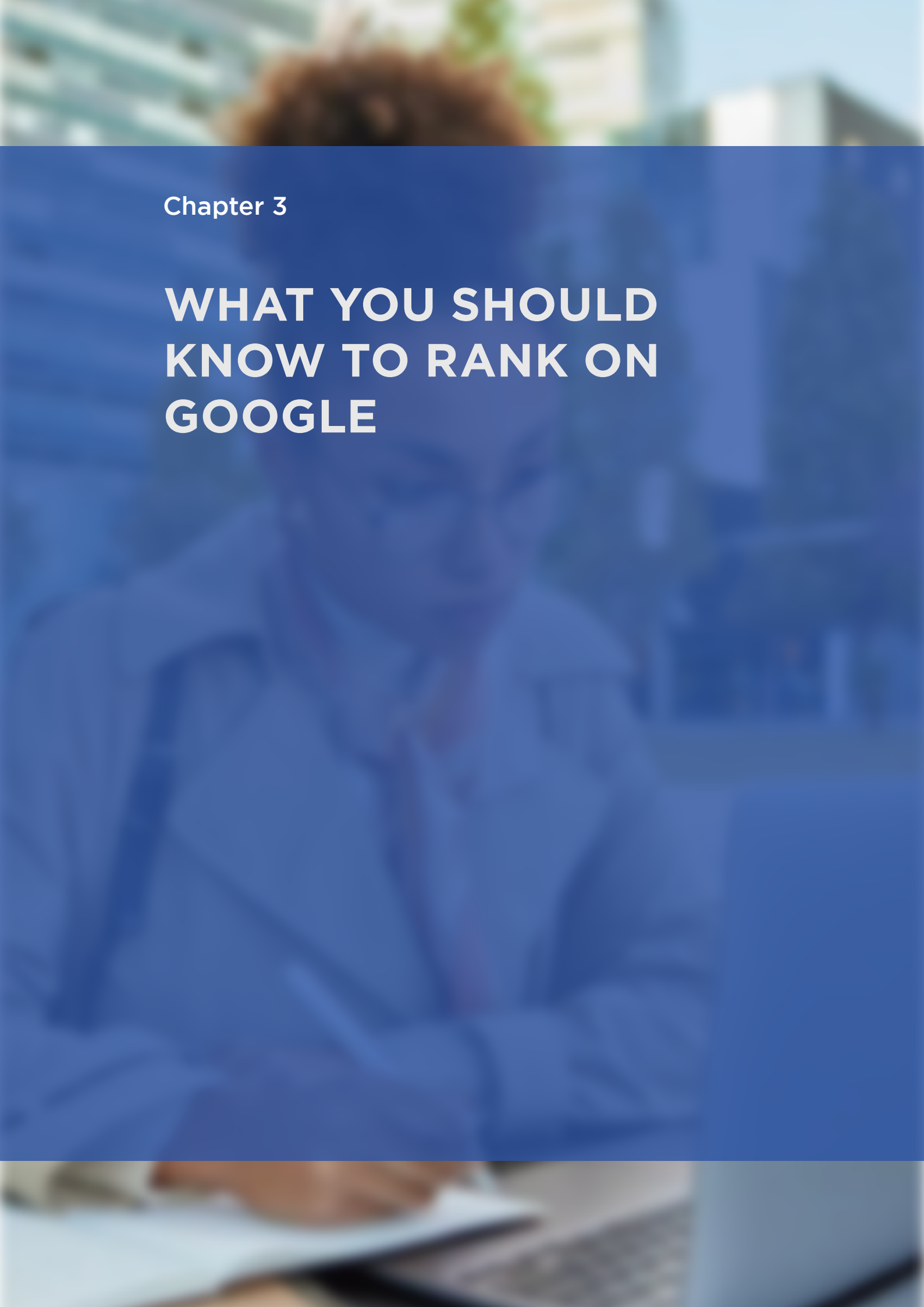
6. Popular SEO strategies that we actively utilize nowadays will no longer bring the desired results.

7. Instead of focusing on keywords, we'll have to learn how to optimize for search snippets.

These are a few thoughts on what website owners may see happening in the upcoming years.

I'm not trying to make things look worse. Not at all. I'm sharing my thoughts to help you prepare for the inevitable changes impacting your website's performance.

Luckily, your website won't be impacted by the Google algorithm updates if you implement the recommendations from the following chapter.



Chapter 3

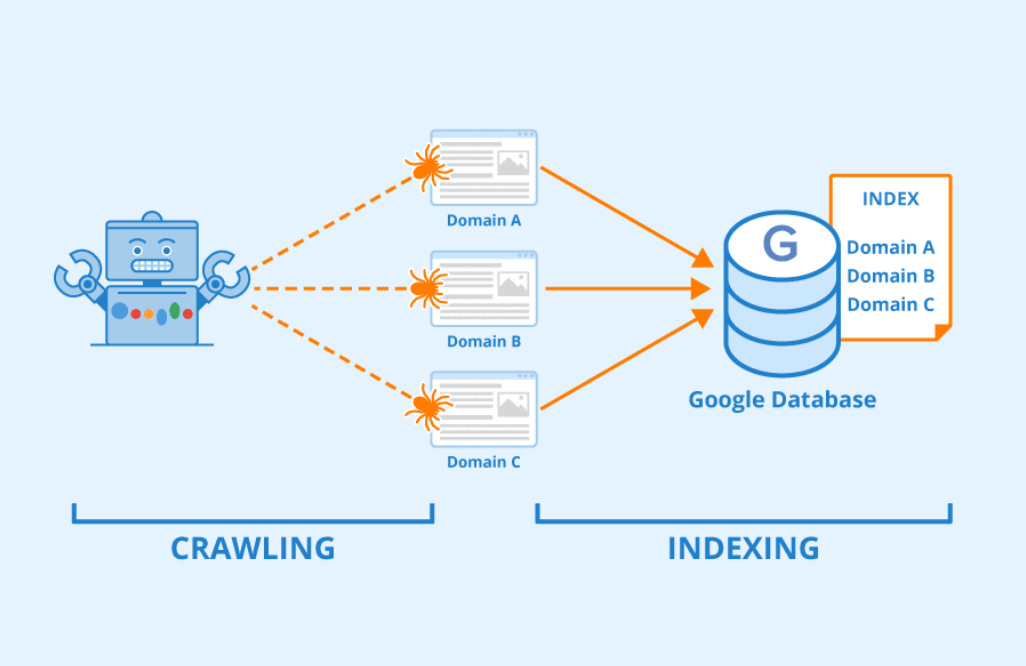
WHAT YOU SHOULD KNOW TO RANK ON GOOGLE

Before learning how to optimize content for rankings, you must know what happens behind the scenes when you hit the “publish” button.

Your web page should go through the following four steps before it becomes searchable on Google:

1. Discovering
2. Crawling
3. Rendering
4. Indexing

Let me briefly explain what happens at every step.



How Google bot crawls and indexes new content. Source: Elegant Themes.

1. Discovering

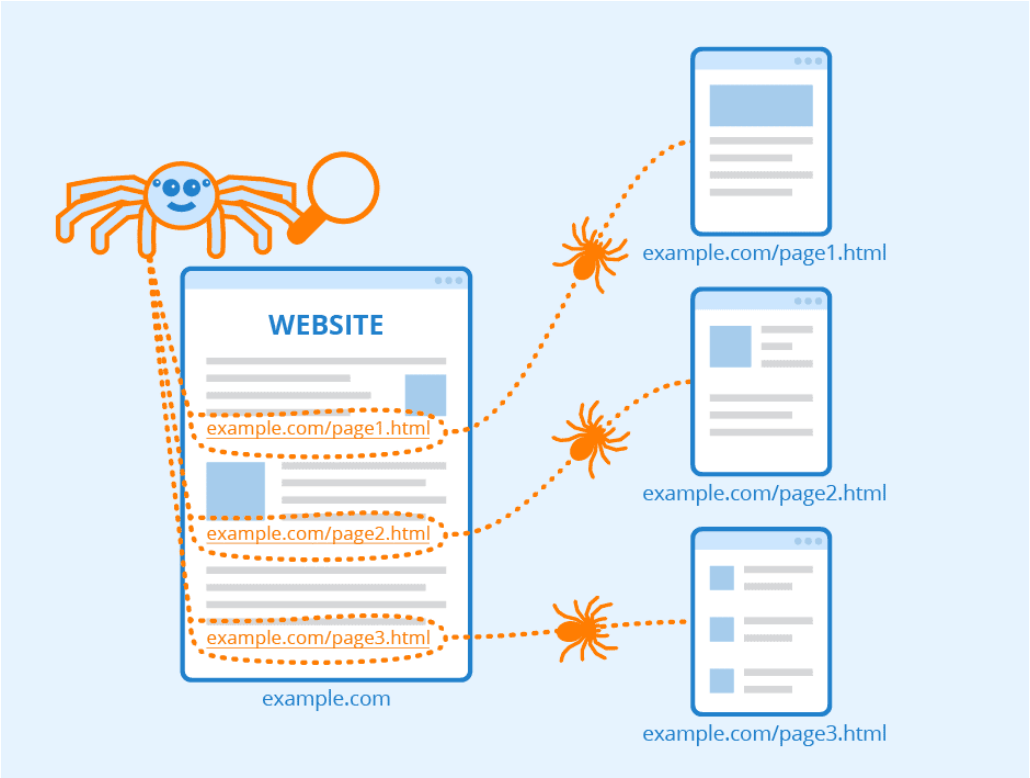
You might think that your newly published article is already available in search results since anyone can access your website’s URL immediately after it’s published on the web.

However, it’s not true!

Even though you can access it through the URL, no one will find it in organic search results since the Google bot (Google’s web crawler) must first discover your newly published URL.

How does it happen?

Google’s bot continuously browses the web to discover new content and recrawls existing pages. It finds new content through internal links on your website or backlinks pointing to your website. As soon as a new piece of content previously unknown to Google is discovered, it starts crawling the URL.



How Google bot crawls and indexes new content. Source: Elegant Themes.

2. Crawling

Once a new web page is discovered, search engine bots systematically crawl through its content, gathering information about its structure, keywords, and overall relevance.

This process involves navigating the page's HTML code, extracting text and links, and analyzing the page's metadata (the title tag and description you see in search results).

Crawling helps search engine bots understand the page's content and context, making it easier to determine its relevance to user queries.

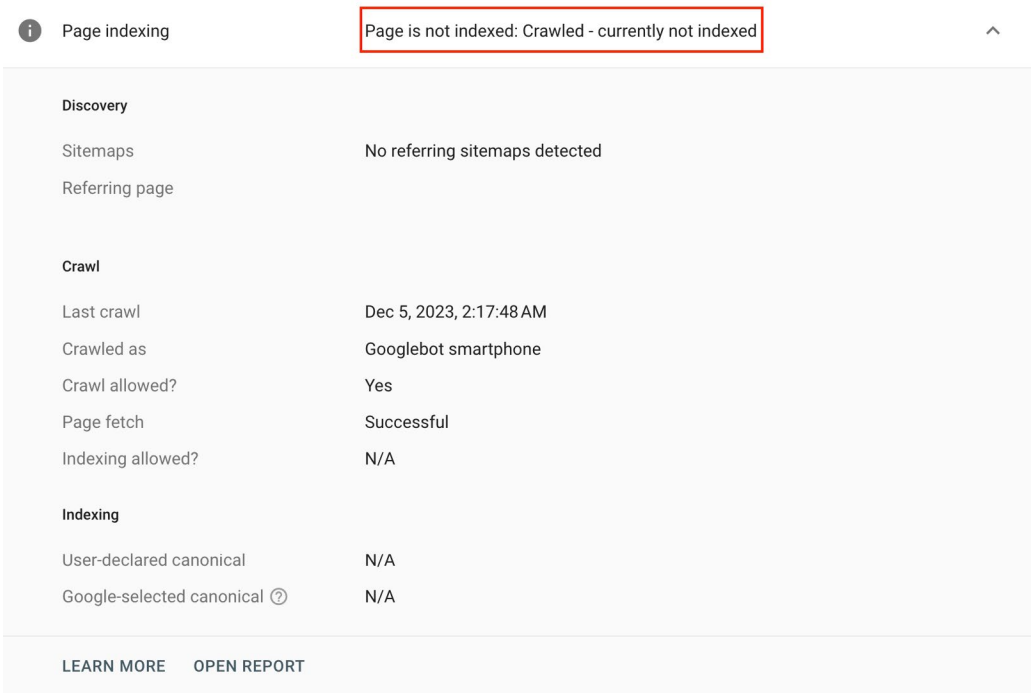
At this point, the Google bot can either move to the next steps or get stuck at this step for a while.

That's why publishing a new web page isn't enough. You must ensure your web page doesn't have **"discovered/crawled — currently not indexed"** issues.

Google gives the following explanation for these issues:

"Crawled – currently not indexed: The page was crawled by Google, but not indexed. It may or may not be indexed in the future; no need to resubmit this URL for crawling.

Discovered – currently not indexed: The page was found by Google, but not crawled yet. Typically, Google wanted to crawl the URL, but this was expected to overload the site; therefore, Google rescheduled the crawl. This is why the last crawl date is empty on the report."



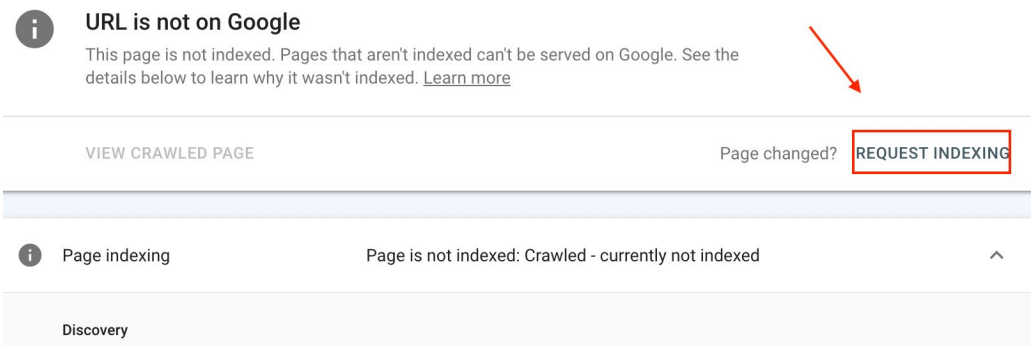
"Crawled – currently not indexed" issue. Source: Google Search Console.

Simply put, Google knows about your web page but decided not to add it to its main index (content storage) because of some issues.

Google does not provide answers or explain what causes these issues and how to fix them.

I have some guesses to explain the reasons behind these issues. Perhaps your server was overloaded when the Google bot was crawling your website, or your website has a low loading speed or poor content quality, to name a few.

Note that it takes up to two weeks for a new website to get indexed. If the issue isn't resolved automatically, try to request indexing through Google Search Console like this.



An issue with indexing. Source: Google Search Console.

3. Rendering

Rendering involves the interpretation and display of web page content. While crawling collects raw data, rendering simulates how a web page appears to users in a browser.

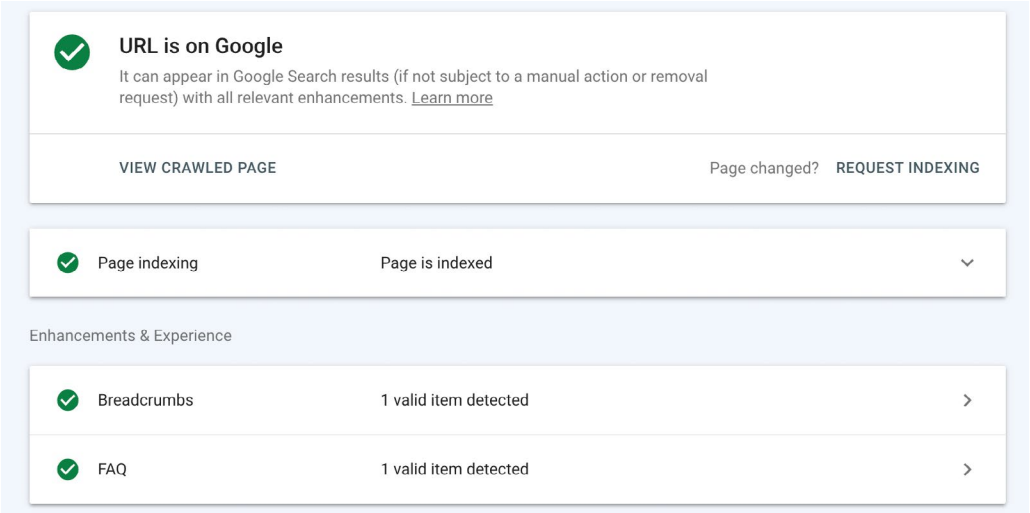
This step is crucial because some content, especially dynamic elements generated by JavaScript, may not be visible in the raw HTML.

By rendering pages, search engines can understand and index the complete user experience, including interactive and dynamically generated content.

4. Indexing

“Your URL is on Google” — that’s the most desired status for all website owners.

If your newly published web page shows this status in Google Search Console, my congratulations! Your web page is available for users on Google.



A "URL is on Google" message. Source: Google Search Console.

Here's what happens behind the scenes:

After crawling and rendering, the search engine stores the extracted information about the webpage in its index, a massive database that maps keywords to web pages.

Indexing involves organizing and structuring the gathered data to allow efficient and fast retrieval of relevant pages for user queries.

Let me repeat it once again to make it clear: **all web pages on your website should be indexed unless you intentionally want to exclude some pages from search results.**

Okay, your web page is on Google now. But what happens next?

In an ideal scenario, your web page should appear in the top 10 organic search results whenever a user inserts your target keyword in a search bar.

If you've already stumbled upon the term "keyword," it's fantastic! If not, it's not a problem. You'll learn everything about keywords in the following paragraph.

What is a keyword?

A keyword is a word or phrase users type into a search engine to find information on a particular topic.

Try to recall the last time you opened the Google search bar. What did you type? Most likely, you wanted to find out something, buy something, or inquire about the direction of a particular store nearby.

Top-ranking search results reflect the work done by SEO experts, who know how to optimize a content piece for a particular keyword, and Google. Because Google believes your web page is relevant to users at a particular moment of time.

Based on users' search intent, keywords can be:

1. Informational ("What's SEO?" "How to rank high on Google?")

2. Commercial ("Buy SEO books," "Affordable SEO tools.")

3. Navigational ("SEO agency in New York.")

As a website owner, you'll be interested in the first two types of keywords. The informational keywords are often less competitive, while commercial keywords can help you earn money.

If you run a local business, you should definitely know the navigational keywords your target audience uses to find businesses similar to yours.

Based on lengths, keywords can be:

1. Single-word phrases (“iPhone,” “t-shirts.”)

2. 2–3 word phrases (“buy iPhone 15,” “Nike shoes.”)

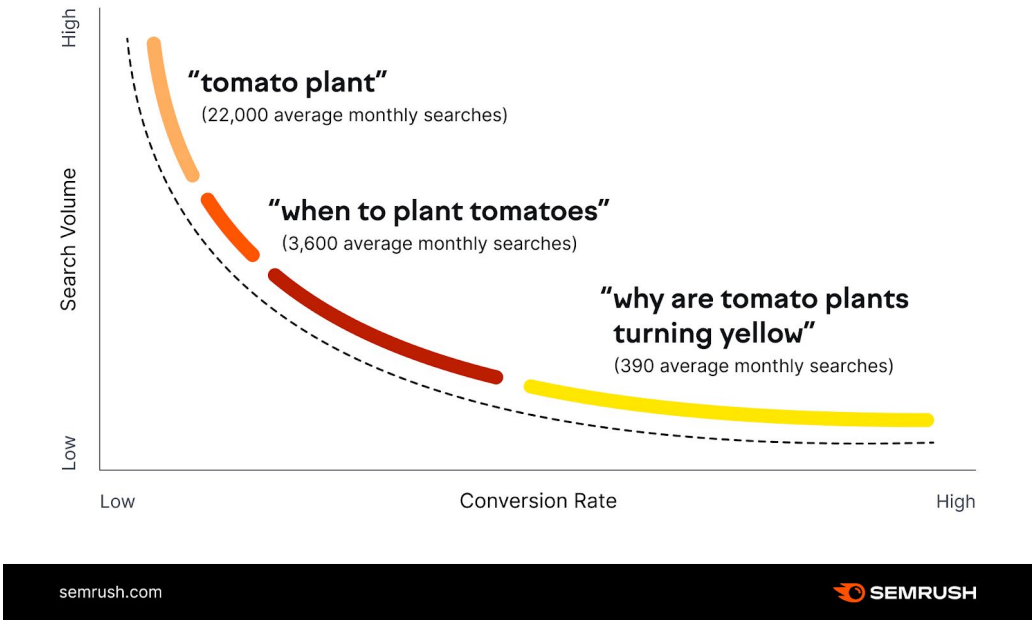
3. Long-tail keywords (“Is buying the latest iPhone worth it?”)

It’s often hard to predict what users want to buy by typing a single word on Google. As a website owner, you won’t know whether their search intent is commercial or informational. However, creating content that satisfies users’ search intent is much easier when targeting medium and long-tail keywords. Moreover, these keywords usually have lower competition, which increases your chances of ranking high in organic search results.

Semrush has an easy-to-grasp graph that illustrates the potential of every keyword type.

Even though “Tomato plant” has the highest monthly search volume, this keyword’s conversion rate is low. Why? Because you don’t know what exactly users want when they google this keyword.

The medium-tail keyword “When to plant tomatoes” and the long-tail keyword “Why are tomato plants turning yellow” are straightforward. You know what exactly users want in both cases. Therefore, creating an article that answers these questions and promotes related products or services is easy.



Types of keywords, according to Semrush.

As you know, keywords are the foundation of search engine visibility, and they play a crucial role in determining how high a website appears in search results pages (SERPs) for specific search queries.

In the following paragraphs, I'll show you how to research medium- and long-tail keywords with informational and commercial search intent.

You'll no longer write content that no one finds and reads online. Instead, you'll have proven-to-work keyword research methods to discover keywords your target audience continuously uses on Google.

Let's move on without further ado!

3 methods to find keywords for your website

As an SEO expert, I use several methods to research keywords. All of these methods have worked for me for years. The more I gained knowledge and experience in SEO, the more I honed my keyword research processes to make them efficient.

I'll explain every method in detail and what you should achieve at the end.

First, I want to say a few words about SEO tools.

I use Semrush for keyword research and analysis. Semrush is an all-in-one SEO tool you can use for various SEO, SMM, and content management tasks. It has a 7-day free trial and a powerful but limited free version.

I've tried multiple SEO tools. I can confidently say Semrush is the best one in terms of price and value for SEO experts, small and established businesses, and startups.

If you are a solopreneur on a budget, I'll recommend a few affordable tools for keyword research in the 7th chapter of this ebook.

I'm excited to teach you my proven keyword research methods. So, let's get started!

Method 1 — Keyword overview

Try to recall the last time you suddenly came up with a random topic and wanted to write an article about it.

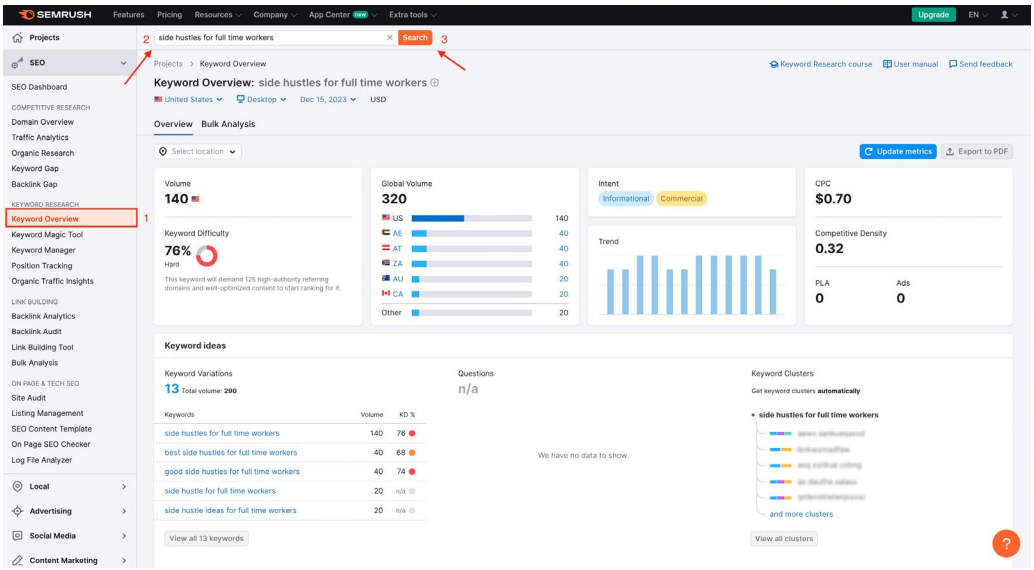
Like you, I generate various writing ideas daily. However, it doesn't mean every idea is worth implementation.

There is an easy method to check whether your topic has a ranking potential. Semrush, like any other SEO tool, has a Keyword Overview report, which you can use to check whether anyone searches for your keyword on the web and how competitive your keyword is.

For example, I came up with a random topic, such as "*side hustles for full-time workers*." It's a pretty relatable topic, isn't it?

Instead of wondering whether it's worth writing an article about it, you can quickly check the keyword potential in Semrush. In our example, you can see that the keyword has 320 monthly global search volume, 140 monthly search volume in the USA, 76 keyword difficulty, and mixed search intent.

I'll teach you how to analyze keywords in the following paragraphs. I want you to get familiar with different keyword research methods and pick the most suitable one.



The Keyword Overview report in Semrush.

Method 2 — Keyword generation

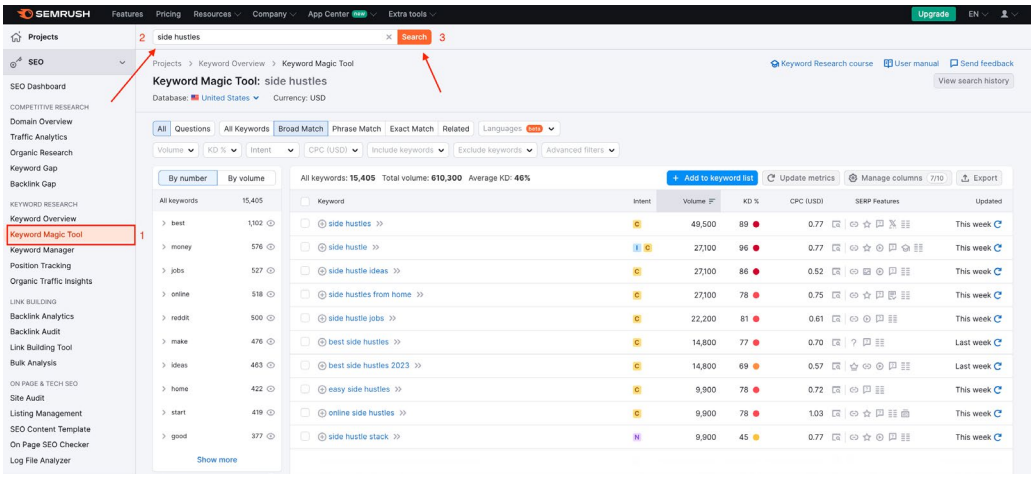
It may happen that your topic idea doesn't have ranking potential. However, it doesn't mean you shouldn't target it. It simply means people use different words to find content on the web.

Instead of manually brainstorming and analyzing every keyword, you can use Semrush Keyword Magic Tool to generate keywords with traffic potential.

Semrush uses your keyword idea to find multiple similar keywords, where each keyword has a search volume.

If you work on your website or manage a client's website, that's a quick way to pick keywords for a content writing plan.

In the following paragraph, I'll show you how to prioritize keywords with money-making potential.

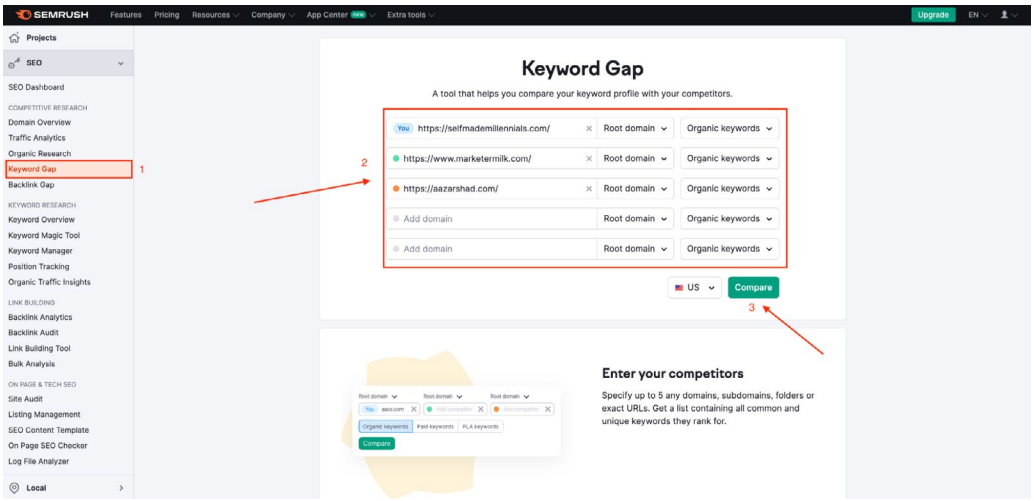


Keyword Magic Tool in Semrush.

Method 3 — Spy on your competitors' keywords

This is rather an advanced method for website owners who have already covered many keywords in their niches and want to know what they're missing.

You can use Semrush's Keyword Gap tool to discover keywords your competitors rank for, but you don't. Add your closest competitors' URLs to the Keyword Gap tool and hit "Compare."



Keyword Gap Tool in Semrush.

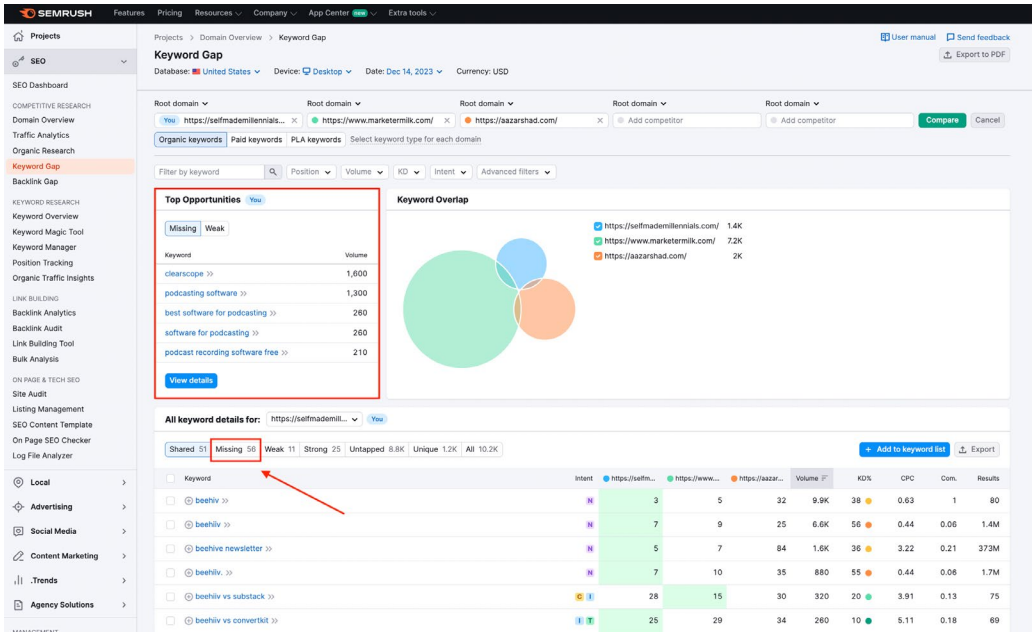
Honestly, that's my favorite keyword research method since you can quickly discover keywords that help your competitors attract the target audience and make money.

The top opportunities are highlighted at the beginning of the report. These are keywords that Semrush believes are the most suitable for your website. However, I recommend checking the "Missing" tab first of all. The "Missing tab" shows all keywords that your competitors rank for in organic search results, but you don't.

In my example below, I only inserted two competitor URLs to discover 56 keywords. However, I can easily discover even more opportunities by adding more competitor URLs.

By default, you can insert up to five competitor URLs at once. That's a lot of keyword ideas for your website.

In the following paragraph, I'll show you how to analyze keywords and pick the most suitable ones for your website.



Keyword gap analysis report in Semrush.

4 metrics to analyze keywords

At this point, you should be able to discover plenty of keywords for your website. However, it doesn't mean every keyword is worth your attention.

The following metrics will help you critically analyze keywords and pick the ones your website can realistically rank for.

Global search volume roughly estimates how often your keyword is searched worldwide per month. Simply put, the higher the search volume, the more popular your keyword is.

Volume in your target country shows how often people search for your keyword on average per month in your target country.

Keyword difficulty helps to understand how competitive your keyword is for ranking. If too many web pages compete for the top ranking positions, reaching the first search engine result page will be challenging. The metric is usually measured on a scale from 0 to 100.

You can use various tools to check these metrics. In my examples, I use Semrush, but I also shared alternative tools for keyword research in chapter seven of this ebook.

There is one more essential metric to check while analyzing keywords — traffic potential. **Traffic potential** shows how much traffic you can realistically get if your web page ranks on the first Google search result page for your target keyword.

Let me put it this way.

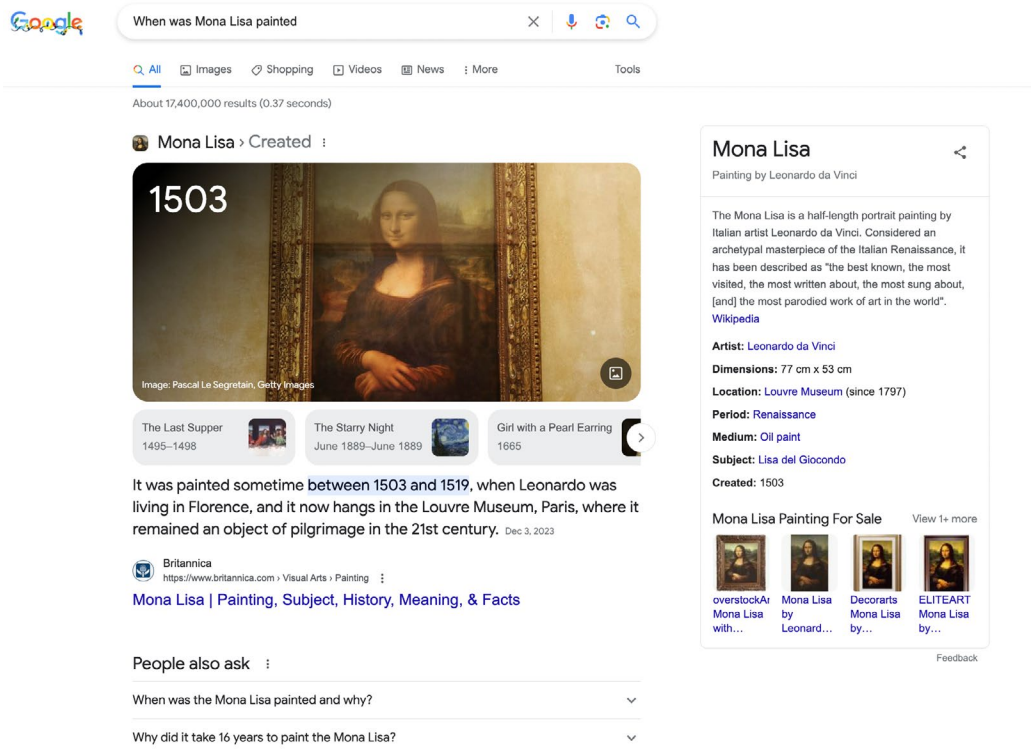
Imagine you want to target the "*side hustles for full time workers*" keyword, which has 140 search volume in the USA. Even if your article ranks first on Google for this keyword, you won't get 140 monthly visitors.

Here is why.

Users can click on other search results from the top 10 positions. Google can show featured snippets for these keywords, answering users' questions right on the spot without the need to open any website. Besides, paid ads can steal your traffic, too.

I’ve seen cases when promising keywords had zero traffic potential. It happens when big websites dominate the web, like Wikipedia, and if Google can answer users’ questions right on the search result page.

For example, here’s what a search engine result page looks like for the *“When was Mona Lisa painted?”* keyword. The answer is right on the page without a need to navigate elsewhere.



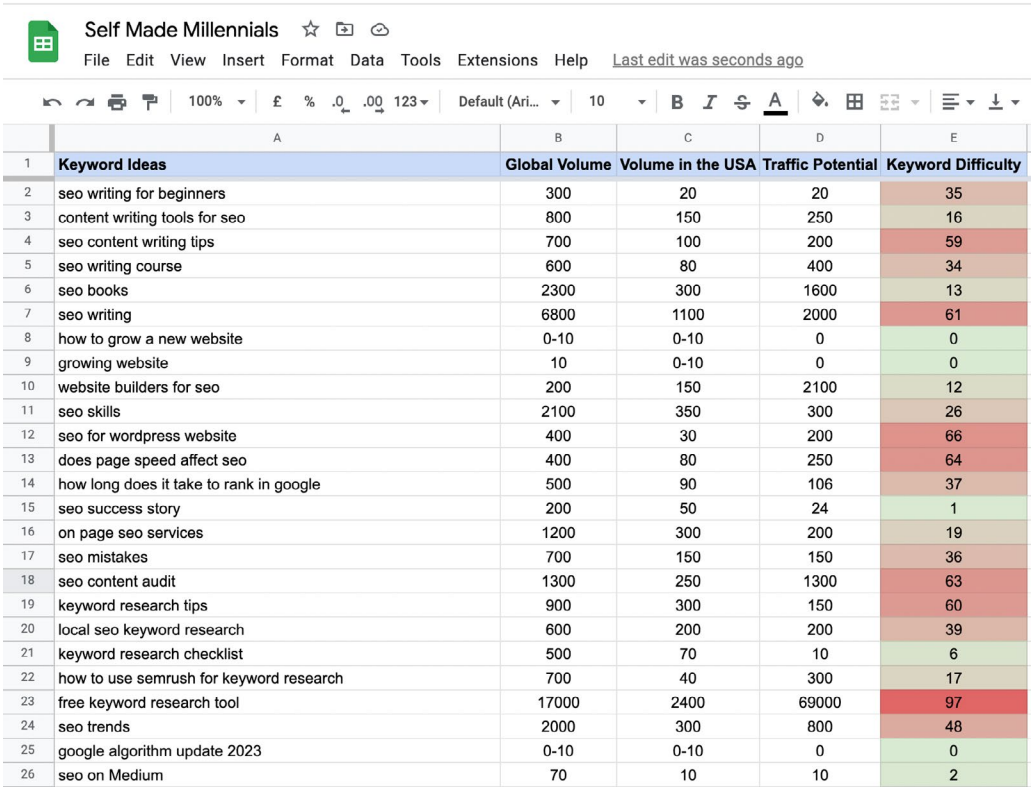
Example of a keyword with zero traffic potential. Source: Google.

Feel free to use the following numbers as a benchmark when researching easy-to-rank keywords with high traffic potential. You can use Semrush to research and analyze keywords. I’ve also shared a list of paid and free keyword research tools in chapter seven of this ebook.

- **Global volume (GV):** 100+
- **Search volume in your target country (SV):** 100+
- **Traffic potential (TP):** 100+
- **Keyword difficult (KD):** <30 (medium competition)

Collect all your keywords in an Excel spreadsheet and write down their GV, SV, TP, and KD. This way, you'll see which ones have higher search volumes with medium and low competition.

In the following paragraph, I'll teach you how to prioritize keywords, but you are already one step closer to picking the most suitable keywords for your website.



Self Made Millennials

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	A	B	C	D	E
1	**Keyword Ideas**	**Global Volume**	**Volume in the USA**	**Traffic Potential**	**Keyword Difficulty**
2	seo writing for beginners	300	20	20	35
3	content writing tools for seo	800	150	250	16
4	seo content writing tips	700	100	200	59
5	seo writing course	600	80	400	34
6	seo books	2300	300	1600	13
7	seo writing	6800	1100	2000	61
8	how to grow a new website	0-10	0-10	0	0
9	growing website	10	0-10	0	0
10	website builders for seo	200	150	2100	12
11	seo skills	2100	350	300	26
12	seo for wordpress website	400	30	200	66
13	does page speed affect seo	400	80	250	64
14	how long does it take to rank in google	500	90	106	37
15	seo success story	200	50	24	1
16	on page seo services	1200	300	200	19
17	seo mistakes	700	150	150	36
18	seo content audit	1300	250	1300	63
19	keyword research tips	900	300	150	60
20	local seo keyword research	600	200	200	39
21	keyword research checklist	500	70	10	6
22	how to use semrush for keyword research	700	40	300	17
23	free keyword research tool	17000	2400	69000	97
24	seo trends	2000	300	800	48
25	google algorithm update 2023	0-10	0-10	0	0
26	seo on Medium	70	10	10	2

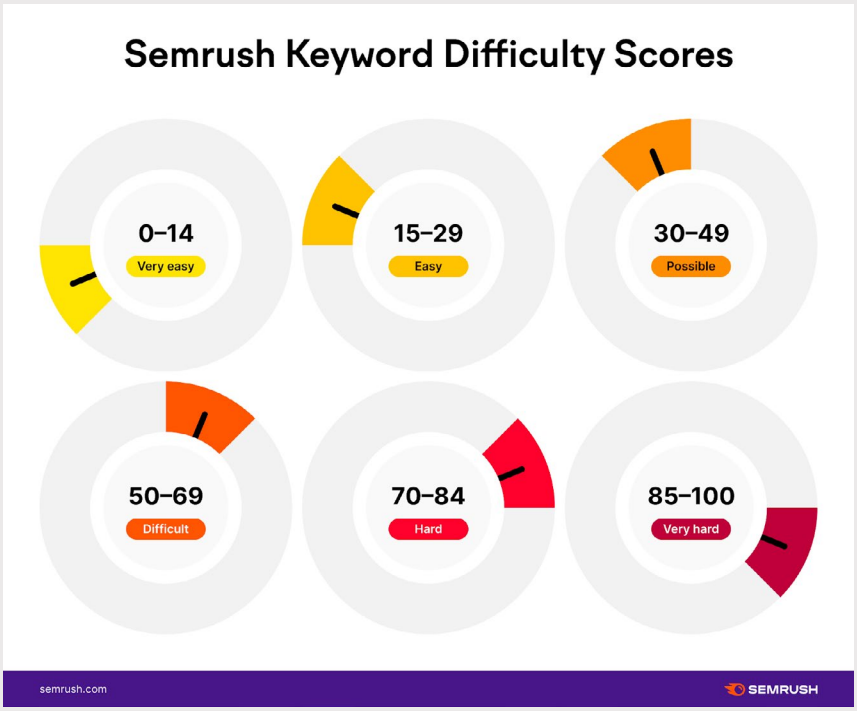
My excel spreadsheet with keyword metrics. Source: Excel

Pro tip

Many tools can help you analyze keywords. Once you pick a tool, I recommend checking how it measures keyword difficulty and search volume.

For example, Semrush measures keyword difficulty on a scale from 0 to 100. It calculates keyword difficulty by analyzing the number of referring domains, the do-follow/no-follow backlink ratio, and various keyword metrics, to name a few.

If your website is new or has a low domain rating (DR), you should prioritize keywords with low keyword difficulty, such as below 14, according to Semrush. Your website will likely rank in the top ten organic search results for such keywords if you create well-researched and optimized content.



Semrush keyword difficulty scores. Source: Semrush.

As to the search volume estimates, the Semrush team says it is an annual average.

Average monthly search volume represents the number of times the keyword was searched over the past year divided by 12. This number could be higher or lower than the average in certain months for seasonal and trending keywords.

How to prioritize keywords

When you are done with keyword research, you have many topics to write about.

What should you start with?

Picking the keywords with the highest search volume isn't always the best strategy. Your ultimate goal is to attract potential customers, not random traffic.

As Tim Soulo, Ahrefs CMO, once well said:



Tim Soulo

CMO and Product advisor at Ahrefs

"The primary goal of growing a blog is acquiring new customers. Treat your blog as a customer acquisition channel, not a traffic acquisition channel."

How do you prioritize keywords to get the highest output from your content?

Focus on keywords with business potential.

Assign 3 points if you answer "yes" to the questions below when analyzing your keywords. The less important keywords will get 1 and 2 points, respectively.

- Can this keyword bring me potential customers?

- Do I have products and services I can offer users who will visit my website through this keyword?

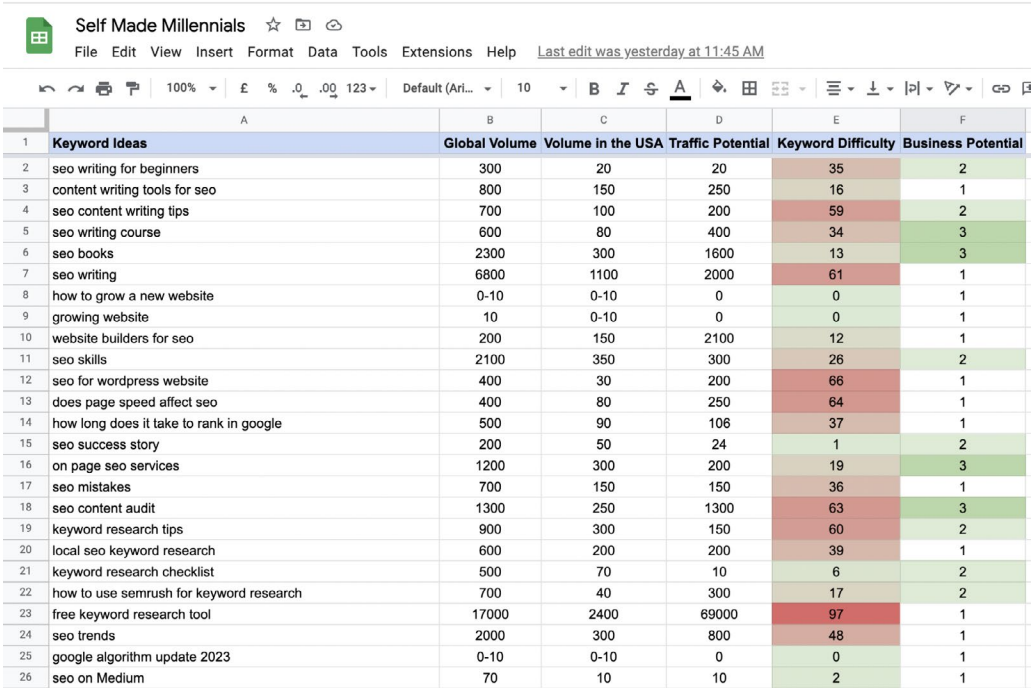
- Can my products solve the needs of people visiting my website through this keyword?

Use these questions to critically assess your keywords and prioritize the ones that will help you make money from your website as soon as possible.

You can assign priorities to your keywords in the same Excel spreadsheet.

The screenshot below shows how I've done it for my website. I've researched many SEO-related keywords. However, the prioritization technique helped me handpick keywords with the search traffic and business potential.

Keywords with 3 and 2 points are the best candidates for content writing.



Self Made Millennials

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	A	B	C	D	E	F
1	**Keyword Ideas**	**Global Volume**	**Volume in the USA**	**Traffic Potential**	**Keyword Difficulty**	**Business Potential**
2	seo writing for beginners	300	20	20	35	2
3	content writing tools for seo	800	150	250	16	1
4	seo content writing tips	700	100	200	59	2
5	seo writing course	600	80	400	34	3
6	seo books	2300	300	1600	13	3
7	seo writing	6800	1100	2000	61	1
8	how to grow a new website	0-10	0-10	0	0	1
9	growing website	10	0-10	0	0	1
10	website builders for seo	200	150	2100	12	1
11	seo skills	2100	350	300	26	2
12	seo for wordpress website	400	30	200	66	1
13	does page speed affect seo	400	80	250	64	1
14	how long does it take to rank in google	500	90	106	37	1
15	seo success story	200	50	24	1	2
16	on page seo services	1200	300	200	19	3
17	seo mistakes	700	150	150	36	1
18	seo content audit	1300	250	1300	63	3
19	keyword research tips	900	300	150	60	2
20	local seo keyword research	600	200	200	39	1
21	keyword research checklist	500	70	10	6	2
22	how to use semrush for keyword research	700	40	300	17	2
23	free keyword research tool	17000	2400	69000	97	1
24	seo trends	2000	300	800	48	1
25	google algorithm update 2023	0-10	0-10	0	0	1
26	seo on Medium	70	10	10	2	1

Analyzing every keyword based on their business potential.

Have you got some juicy keywords to focus on?

Let me show you how you can create a content writing plan that you can use for your website.

How to create a content plan

A content plan is a schedule of what you will publish on your website and when.

Having a content plan helps save time and plan your resources in advance.

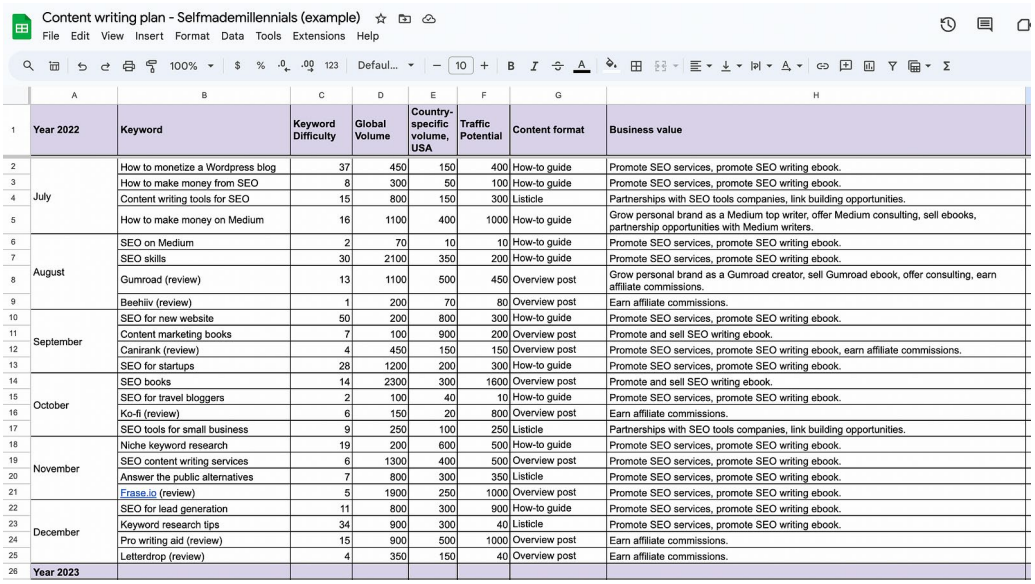
As a website owner and an SEO writer, I usually prepare a content plan in advance for at least six months (ideally, for 12 months).

Here is an example of the content plan I've created for my website with the following goals:

- Attract users interested in SEO writing to grow my email list and sell my digital products.

- Increase affiliate income through product reviews.

Feel free to replicate this content plan format. It's the simplest yet effective way to stay on top of your content creation process.



Content writing plan - Selfmademillennials (example)

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	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
1	**Year 2022**	**Keyword**	**Keyword Difficulty**	**Global Volume**	**Country-specific volume, USA**	**Traffic Potential**	**Content format**	**Business value**
2	July	How to monetize a Wordpress blog	37	450	150	400	How-to guide	Promote SEO services, promote SEO writing ebook.
3		How to make money from SEO	8	300	50	100	How-to guide	Promote SEO services, promote SEO writing ebook.
4		Content writing tools for SEO	15	800	150	300	Listicle	Partnerships with SEO tools companies, link building opportunities.
5		How to make money on Medium	16	1100	400	1000	How-to guide	Grow personal brand as a Medium top writer, offer Medium consulting, sell ebooks, partnership opportunities with Medium writers.
6	August	SEO on Medium	2	70	10	10	How-to guide	Promote SEO services, promote SEO writing ebook.
7		SEO skills	30	2100	350	200	How-to guide	Promote SEO services, promote SEO writing ebook.
8		Gumroad (review)	13	1100	500	450	Overview post	Grow personal brand as a Gumroad creator, sell Gumroad ebook, offer consulting, earn affiliate commissions.
9		Beehiiv (review)	1	200	70	80	Overview post	Earn affiliate commissions.
10	September	SEO for new website	50	200	800	300	How-to guide	Promote SEO services, promote SEO writing ebook.
11		Content marketing books	7	100	900	200	Overview post	Promote and sell SEO writing ebook.
12		Canirank (review)	4	450	150	150	Overview post	Promote SEO services, promote SEO writing ebook, earn affiliate commissions.
13		SEO for startups	28	1200	200	300	How-to guide	Promote SEO services, promote SEO writing ebook.
14	October	SEO books	14	2300	300	1600	Overview post	Promote and sell SEO writing ebook.
15		SEO for travel bloggers	2	100	40	10	How-to guide	Promote SEO services, promote SEO writing ebook.
16		Ko-fi (review)	6	150	20	800	Overview post	Earn affiliate commissions.
17		SEO tools for small business	9	250	100	250	Listicle	Partnerships with SEO tools companies, link building opportunities.
18	November	Niche keyword research	19	200	600	500	How-to guide	Promote SEO services, promote SEO writing ebook.
19		SEO content writing services	6	1300	400	500	Overview post	Promote SEO services, promote SEO writing ebook.
20		Answer the public alternatives	7	800	300	350	Listicle	Promote SEO services, promote SEO writing ebook.
21		Frase.io (review)	5	1900	250	1000	Overview post	Promote SEO services, promote SEO writing ebook.
22	December	SEO for lead generation	11	800	300	900	How-to guide	Promote SEO services, promote SEO writing ebook.
23		Keyword research tips	34	900	300	40	Listicle	Promote SEO services, promote SEO writing ebook.
24		Pro writing aid (review)	15	900	500	1000	Overview post	Earn affiliate commissions.
25		Letterdrop (review)	4	350	150	40	Overview post	Earn affiliate commissions.
26	**Year 2023**							

Example of the content writing plan I created for my website.

In addition to locating keywords in the order of priority, I recommend adding a few more details to the content plan that will make it more informative for you and your team:

- Business value

- Content format

Remember that organic traffic acquisition shouldn't be your primary goal!

Every article should help you achieve your business goals, whether it is lead generation, product sales, or email list growth.

Content format, on the other hand, will help you grasp how your content should be structured.

I know it's often unclear what your article should cover to satisfy user search intent. Should it be a listicle, a guide, a checklist, or a landing page? A short article may be enough for users to get all answers, but search engines may consider it uninformative. On the other hand, including too many irrelevant details won't help your web page rank high either.

In the following paragraph, I'll share strategies that will help you analyze search intent and structure your article the right way.

How to analyze search intent

After analyzing users' **search intent**, you'll know exactly what to write about and how to structure your content.

Search intent is the "why" behind users' queries. In other words, this is the reason why users type their search queries in the Google search bar.

If users search for answers, their search intent is *informational*. If they want to buy something, it's *commercial*. If they want to navigate somewhere, it's *navigational*.

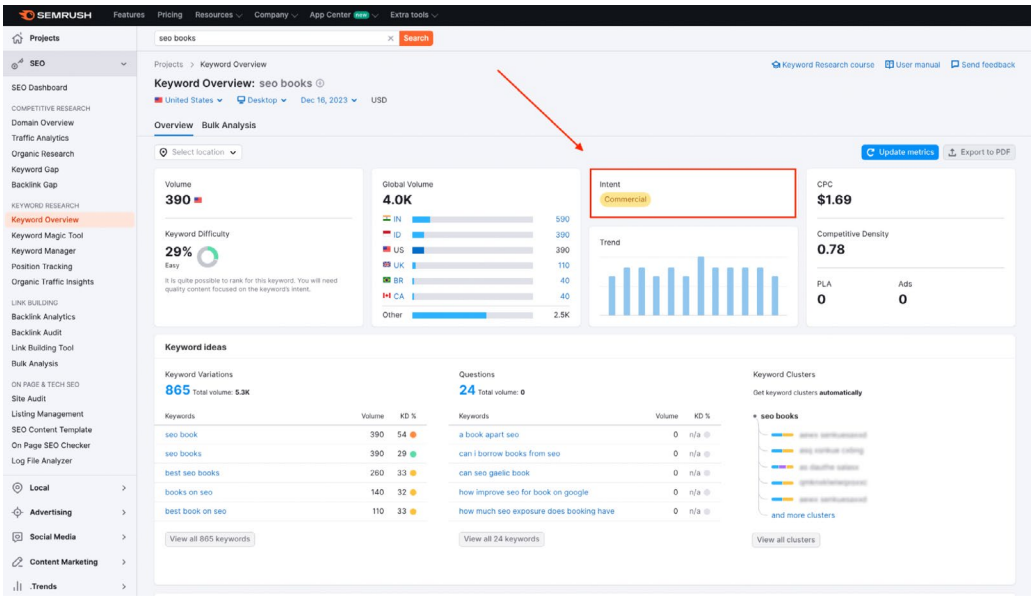
Aligning your content with search intent is essential nowadays because Google aims to serve users with the most relevant content at a particular moment in time.

Additionally, you'll only be able to sell your products or services if your keyword has a commercial search intent.

I'll show you how to analyze search intent with the help of Semrush and manually.

Semrush shows search intent for every keyword as a part of its keyword overview report.

In my example, the search intent for the "SEO books" keyword is commercial, which means people use this keyword to buy books.



Keyword search intent in Semrush.

However, does it mean you should create a landing page targeting this keyword to sell books? No!

First, you must analyze search intent carefully before creating optimized content. Here's how: check the structure of the top 10 organic search results for your target keyword.

Since Google has the most extensive online user behavior database, it knows exactly what users want to see for every keyword and what content structure works best.

I prefer using Semrush's or Ahrefs' SERP checkers, but you can also manually review the top 10 ranking pages for your target keyword.

In my example, all of the top-ranking pages are listicles. It means users want to know what SEO books exist and quickly pick one for reading. If you want to target this keyword, you definitely have to write a better and catchier listicle since shoehoning a landing page into the top search results won't work!

SERP overview for "seo books"

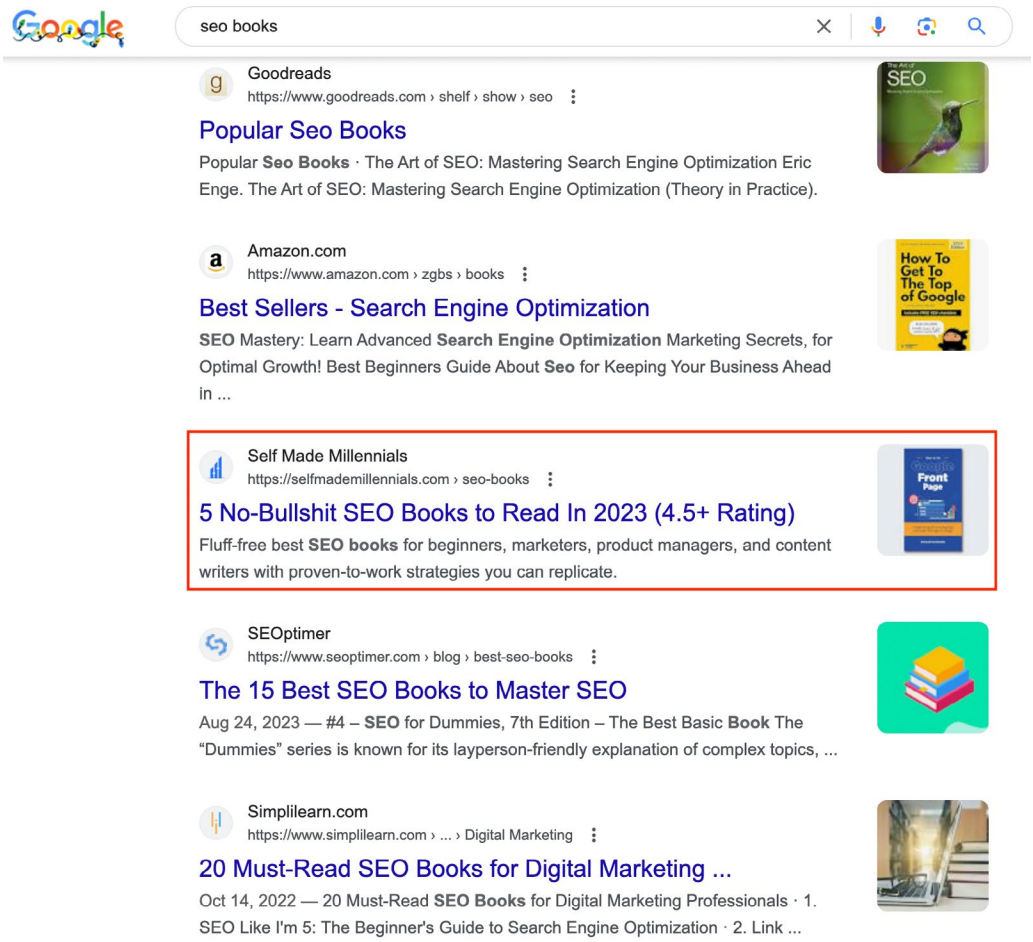
SERP updated 22 days ago

	Search result	DR	UR	Backlinks	Domains	Traffic	Keywords
1	The 11 Best SEO Books You Should Read https://www.searchenginejournal.com/best-s...	91	15	270	134	884	57
2	› People also ask						
3	Best Search Engine Optimization https://www.amazon.com/Best-Sellers-Searc...	96	0	4	4	391	86
4	I Read 26 Best SEO Books on Amazon (Here's... https://www.gotchseo.com/best-seo-books/	73	6	28	19	420	110
5	The 6 SEO Books That Are Worth Reading In ... https://www.searchlogistics.com/learn/seo/b... › 3 siteLinks						

SERP overview for "SEO books." Source: Ahrefs.

Even though manual SERP checking isn't always accurate, you can use it to quickly define search intent.

In my example, most top-ranking pages targeting the "SEO books" keyword are listicles. Unsurprisingly, my website also ranks on top! I achieved it by conducting keyword research, analyzing search intent, and identifying how the article should be structured to satisfy users and Google.



Manual SERP overview for "SEO books."

You already know how to conduct keyword research and analyze search intent. In the next paragraph, I'll teach you how to structure your article to answer user search intent.

How to structure your content

Imagine you want to write an article about SEO books.

You already know your target keyword has decent search traffic potential, bearable keyword difficulty, and commercial search intent. However, how do you know what to write about? Should your article have three, five, or more paragraphs? What those paragraphs should cover? And how to ensure your article answers users' search intent?

These are just a few questions to consider when writing your article.

I know some writers create outlines solely based on their judgment. However, that's not the best strategy. You may miss essential details if you don't know the niche well. However, even if you create content for your niche, you can forget to include important information.

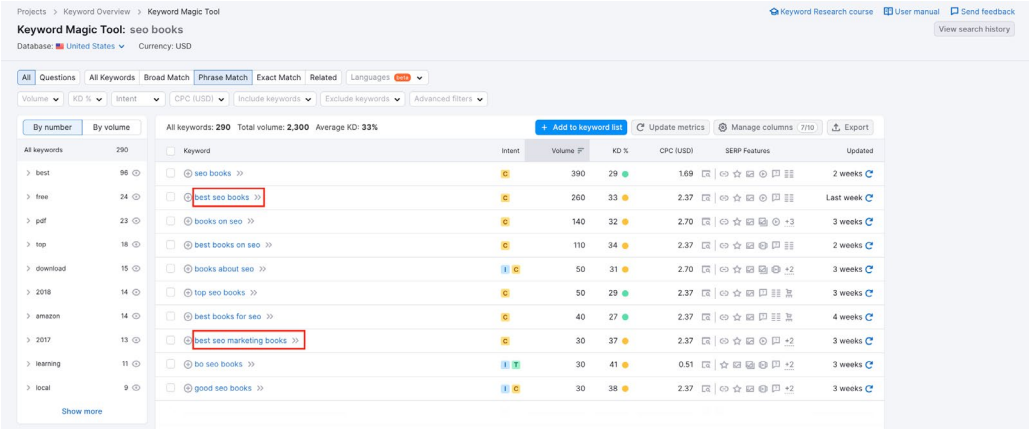
If users don't find your article helpful, they'll likely return to search results and navigate to another website. Sooner or later, Google will notice this pattern and push your article down in organic search results. You don't want this to happen. Therefore, let me show you how to align your content with users' search intent.

1. Collect semantically related keywords

Semantically related keywords are the ones closely related to your target keyword.

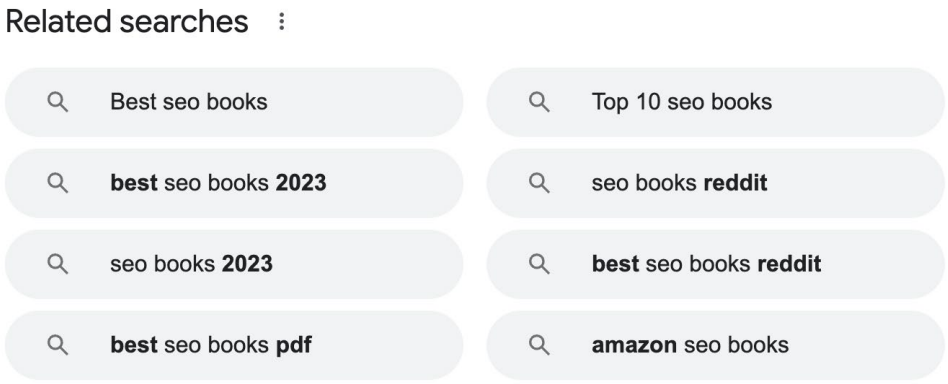
There are many ways to find semantically related keywords. Feel free to use the most suitable method for you. They are all reliable and will help you better understand what your target audience wants to know about your topic.

First, you can use Semrush's "Related," "Phrase match," "Broad match," and "Questions" reports to find semantically related keywords. Other SEO tools, like Ahrefs and Mangools, have similar reports. So, it doesn't really matter which SEO tool you use.

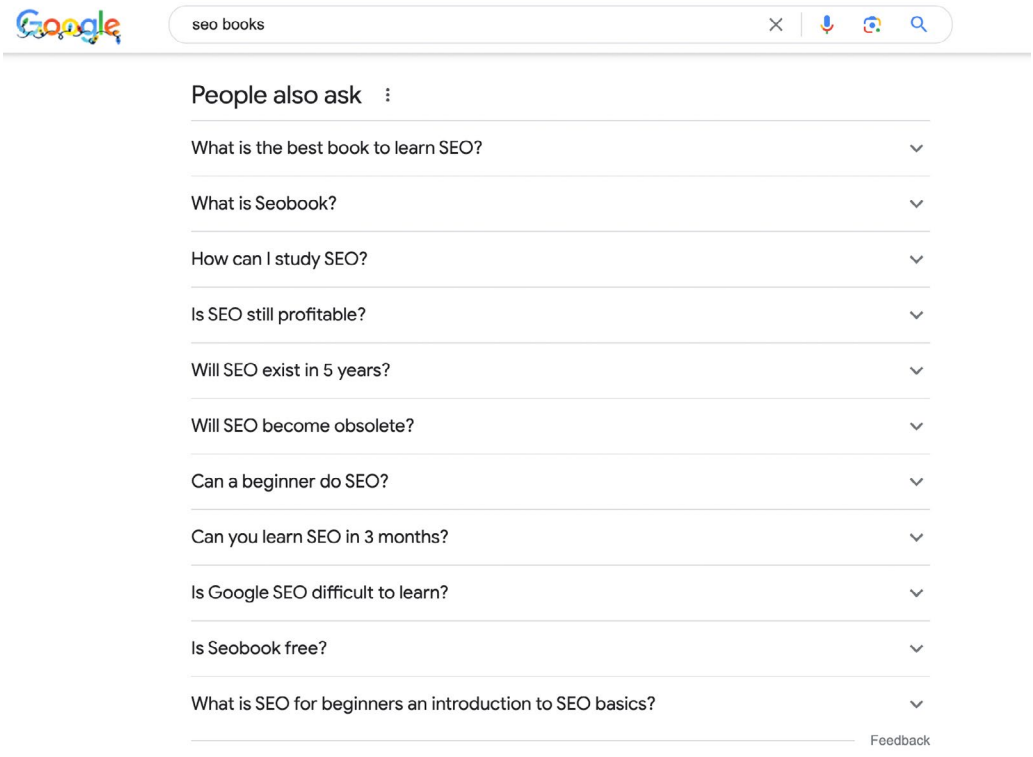


How to find semantically related keywords with Semrush.

The Google search result page also shares many insights about users' search intent. In particular, you can find semantically related keywords in the "People also ask" and "Related searches" sections.

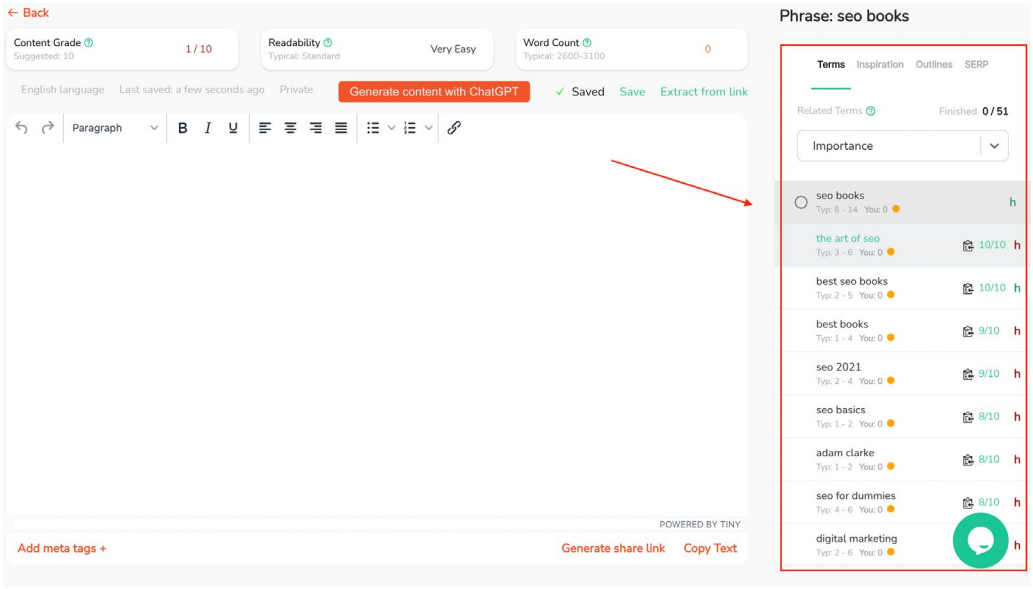


Google's related searches for the "SEO books" keyword. Source: Google search results.



The "People also ask" section on Google. Source: Google search results.

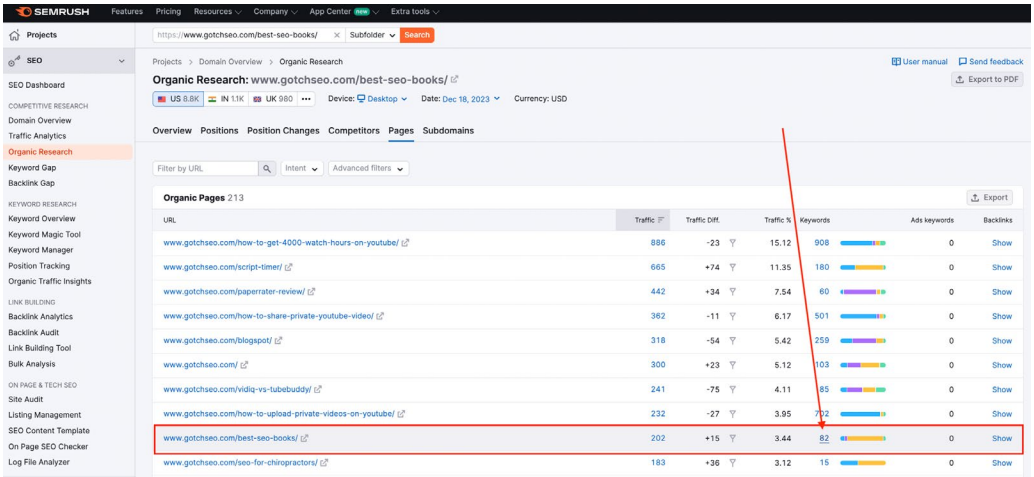
You can also check recommendations provided by AI SEO writing tools. For example, I use Robinize's free version to collect related terms. Not all recommendations are worth implementing, but the tool provides a decent list of related keywords.



Robinze is an AI-powered SEO tool that also recommends related terms for writing.

I recommend using one more advanced method if you have access to a professional SEO tool, like Semrush or Ahrefs.

You can check the keywords your top-ranking competitors rank for. This way, you'll quickly discover keywords your article should cover.



How to check the keywords your competitors rank for. Source: Semrush.

2. Create a table with semantically related keywords

Collecting semantically related keywords from various resources can be challenging. Therefore, I always recommend creating a table with a list of keywords to help you see a broader picture and grasp what your article should cover.

Here's what I collected for the "SEO books" keyword:

Best books for search engine optimization
Best books for seo
Top books for seo
Seo marketing books
Seo workbook
Seo 2024
Adam Clarke
Eli Schwartz
Ecommerce seo mastery
Books to learn seo
Free seo books
SEO copywriting books
Local seo books
Best seo books for beginners
Best books on seo and sem
Seo business books
What are the best books on seo

The table shows a few semantically related keywords. These keywords give you an overview of what users want to know when they look for the "SEO books" keyword. You can always add more keywords. However, there's already a lot of data to work with.

3. Check competitors' word count

If top-ranking articles have over 4,000 words, but your article is 1,500, chances are low that it will rank high in organic search results.

Therefore, you must know the length of the top-ranking articles. This data will give you a rough estimate of how long your article should be.

In my example, I've checked the word count of the following articles:

> *"The 11 Best SEO Books You Should Read"* by Search Engine Journal — roughly 1,200 words.
>
> *"THE 6 SEO BOOKS THAT ARE WORTH READING IN 2024"* by Search Logistics — roughly 2,600 words.
>
> *"I Read 26 of the Best SEO Books on Amazon (Here's the Top 5 for 2023)"* by Gotch SEO — roughly 2,400 words.
>
> *"The 15 Best SEO Books to Master SEO"* by SEOptimizer — roughly 2,100 words.

This data isn't perfect, but it provides valuable insights into how long your article should be to hit the Google front page.

If I were to write an article about SEO books (which I did), I'd write at least 2,500 words.

4. Create an article outline

You already know what users want to learn while searching for your target keyword. Now, it's time to create a data-driven outline.

Don't limit your creativity here, but ensure your article answers users' search intent.

Here's how I outlined my article about SEO books, which has ranked in the top 10 organic search results for over a year. Remember that this keyword is time-sensitive. Therefore, the content requires yearly updates.

H1: 5 No-Bullshit SEO Books to Read In 2024

> *H2: What are the best books on SEO in 2024?*
>
> *H2: Product-led SEO by Eli Schwartz*
>
> *H2: How to Write Blog Posts that Hit the Google Front Page by Victoria Kurichenko*
>
> *H2: Ecommerce SEO Ebook Mastery by Kristina Azarenko*
>
> *H2: SEO Book for Beginners by Ahrefs*
>
> *H2: SEO 2022 by Adam Clarke*
>
> *H2: Need help writing optimized content for your website?*

Once the outline is ready, you can start writing your article!

There are still a few things left to do to align your content with Google's requirements and implement optimization strategies. I will teach you how to do it in the following paragraphs.

How to align your content with Google's content quality requirements

How do you think Google determines what websites to show in the top 10 search results if most of the content is AI-generated these days?

Google has developed multiple algorithms to identify helpful content among all the garbage that continuously fills the web. I've covered some of the most important Google algorithm updates at the beginning of the book. You can reread the chapter one.

In this paragraph, I'll share what you can and should do to meet Google's content quality requirements. Although Google's search quality evaluator guidelines are 168 pages long, I'll focus on the most important things.

Let's start!

What's E-E-A-T?

E-E-A-T stands for Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, and Trustworthiness. These are the four key factors that Google considers when evaluating the quality of a website or piece of content. Websites and content that exhibit strong E-E-A-T signals are more likely to rank higher in Google organic search results.

Experience refers to the overall history and track record of a website or content creator. This includes factors such as domain age, website traffic, and social media engagement. Generally speaking, websites and content creators with a longer history and more established presence are considered to have more experience.

Expertise refers to the knowledge and skills of the content creators. This includes factors such as educational background, professional

credentials, and relevant experience. Content written by experts is more likely to be considered authoritative and trustworthy.

Authoritativeness refers to the overall quality and credibility of the content. This includes factors such as accuracy, thoroughness, and originality. Well-researched, well-written, and informative content is more likely to be considered authoritative.

Trustworthiness refers to the overall impression of honesty and integrity that a website conveys. It includes factors such as unbiasedness, transparency, and avoiding self-promotion. Honest, transparent, and respectful content is more likely to be considered trustworthy.

How to optimize for E-E-A-T

E-E-A-T helps Google better understand who runs a website and whether a site owner/content creator has enough expertise to rank in organic search results.

Based on my experience, content aligned with E-E-A-T generates impressions and ranks on Google even if it's published on a new or weak domain.

Here are some specific tips for aligning your content with E-E-A-T:

- Maintain a consistent brand voice and tone. Be clear, concise, and professional.
- Include personal opinion in your content.
- Share case studies (if you have any).
- Explain how you are related to the niche you write about.

- Mention rewards and certificates if you have any.
- Use author bio.
- Grow your personal brand.
- Build relationships with other experts in your field. Guest post on their websites, participate in their discussions and collaborate on projects.

None of the AI tools will be able to tick all the points from this list.

By following these tips, you can build a website or create content that Google values and users trust.

The impact of UX on SEO

There are a few more things to know before you can align your content with Google's content quality requirements.

User experience on your web page is as important as explaining to your target audience why they can trust you.

A positive user experience can lead to higher engagement, lower bounce rate (fewer users will drop from your website right after landing on it), and better click-through rate, which can, in return, positively impact SEO.

In contrast, poor UX can negatively impact user behavior and lead to lower search rankings.

According to the UX Design Institute, businesses that improve the UX design of their websites can achieve conversion rates as high as 400% because research studies prove that 66% of customers are willing to pay more for a great user experience.

So, providing a great user experience isn't only good for SEO. It can also help you improve your business goals.

You can implement the following changes to improve the UX of your website:

- If your website loads slowly, you can compress images to reduce file sizes and switch to a better hosting service provider.
- Create a clear and intuitive navigation structure to make it easy for users to find what they're looking for.
- Use white space and visual hierarchy to organize content and make it easy to read (I'll talk more about readability later in the article).
- Use clear and descriptive page headings.
- Use internal linking to guide users to related content and keep them engaged.
- Use descriptive and meaningful URLs that make it easy for users and search engines to understand your content.
- Ensure that forms and other interactive elements are easy to use and understand.
- Use a mix of text, images, and videos to create engaging and visually appealing content.
- Regularly update old content to keep it fresh and relevant.

Have you implemented any of these recommendations on your website? If not, no worries! Now, you know little tricks that can help you improve user experience on your website.

How to optimize your content to rank on Google

You may think this is one of the most important chapters of this ebook since I'll reveal the optimization strategies you can use to rank content in organic search results.

You are right!

However, on-page optimization always comes after keyword research, search intent analysis, and writing.

Professional SEO writers can combine content writing and on-page optimization. However, you can also optimize your content when it's already written.

In the following paragraph, I'll teach you my proven-to-work on-page optimization techniques that help me grow my website and client websites.

I've tested many strategies in the past years of my SEO career. Some didn't survive after Google algorithm updates. Others, however, have proven to work well when combined with all other steps from the previous paragraphs.

Therefore, let me ask if you've already done keyword research, search intent analysis, article structure planning, and writing.

Once you are ready, move on to the on-page optimization strategies.

1. Optimize the H1 title tag

According to John Mueller, a Google search advocate, here's why you should pay attention to the title of your content:



John Mueller

Webmaster Trends Analyst at Google

"Headings on a page help us to better understand the content on the page. They are not the only ranking factor that we have — we look at the content on its own, as well.

But sometimes having a clear heading on the page gives us a little bit more information on what that section is about."

John Mueller refers to the H1 title tag as a ranking factor that Google uses to understand the content and assess how relevant a particular page is to a user's query.

Even though Google is much smarter these days than it was a decade ago, it still uses keywords to grasp what your web page is about. Therefore, ensure you include your target keyword in the H1 tag.

Website owners also wonder how many H1 title tags can be used on one web page.

Here are the latest insights from John Mueller:



John Mueller

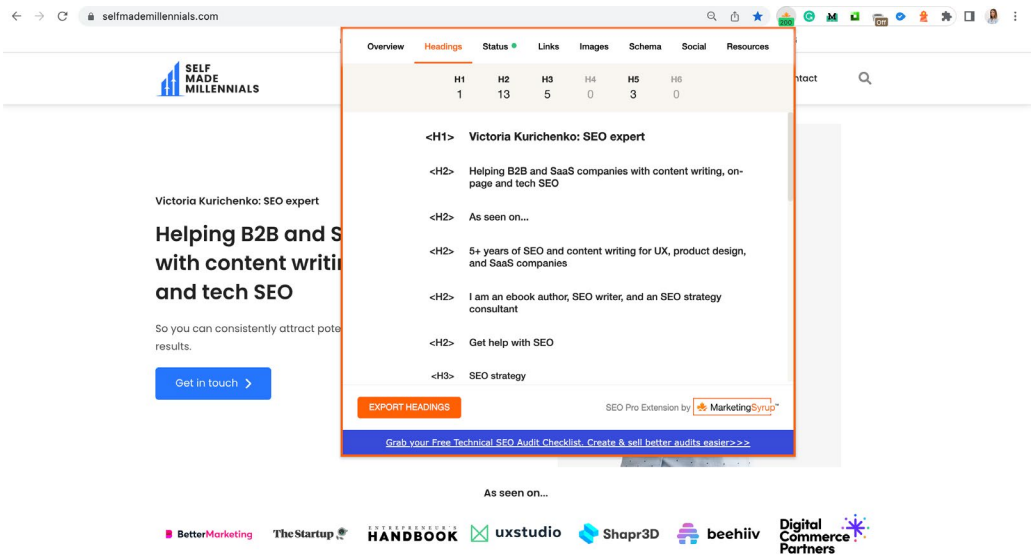
Webmaster Trends Analyst at Google

"This is a pretty common question, and it's pretty straightforward. Our systems don't have a problem when it comes to multiple h1 headings on a page.

That's a fairly common pattern on the web. We use headings to better understand the context of different parts of a page."

So, yes, you can use multiple H1 title tags if you want to or if that's how your content management system works.

You can check your web page headings and the number of H1 title tags using free Google extensions, such as the SEO Pro extension.



How to check headlines and title tags on your website. Source: SEO Pro free Google extension.

2. Optimize the meta title and meta description

Don’t confuse the H1 tag (the title of your article) with the meta title. They serve different purposes.

The H1 tag signals that users are in the right place to read the content they came for.

Follow these tips, to align your meta title and meta description with Google’s best practices:

1. Use your target keyword in the meta title.

2. Use your target keyword and/or semantically related keywords in the meta description.

3. Keep your meta title between 50 and 60 characters.

4. Keep your meta description between 150 and 160 characters. Use the power words to evoke emotions.

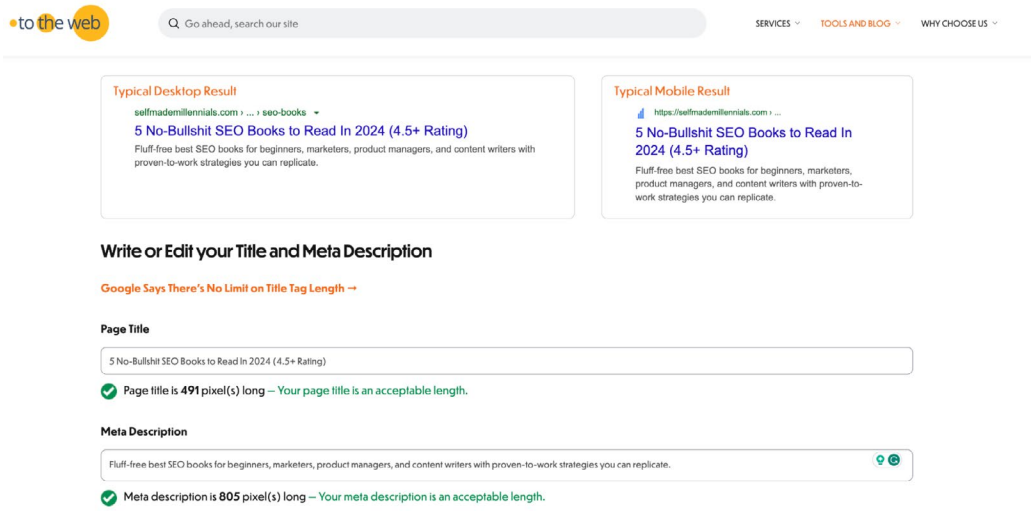
5. Use the power words to evoke emotions.

6. Add the current year to the meta title where appropriate.

7. Use brackets, colons, and dashes to make your meta title stand out.

I recommend using the free To The Web tool to check what the meta title and meta description will look like on desktop and mobile devices.

The tool allows you to change your metadata if it's too long or short.



How to preview the meta title and meta description. Source: To The Web.

3. Optimize the introduction

Don't underestimate the power of introductions.

The first paragraph determines whether people will keep reading your content or skim and leave. Your introduction should be catchy for readers and optimized for search engines.

As an SEO expert and content writer, I recommend the following strategies to optimize an introduction:

- Insert your target keyword and 1–2 semantically related keywords in the first 300 words of your article.

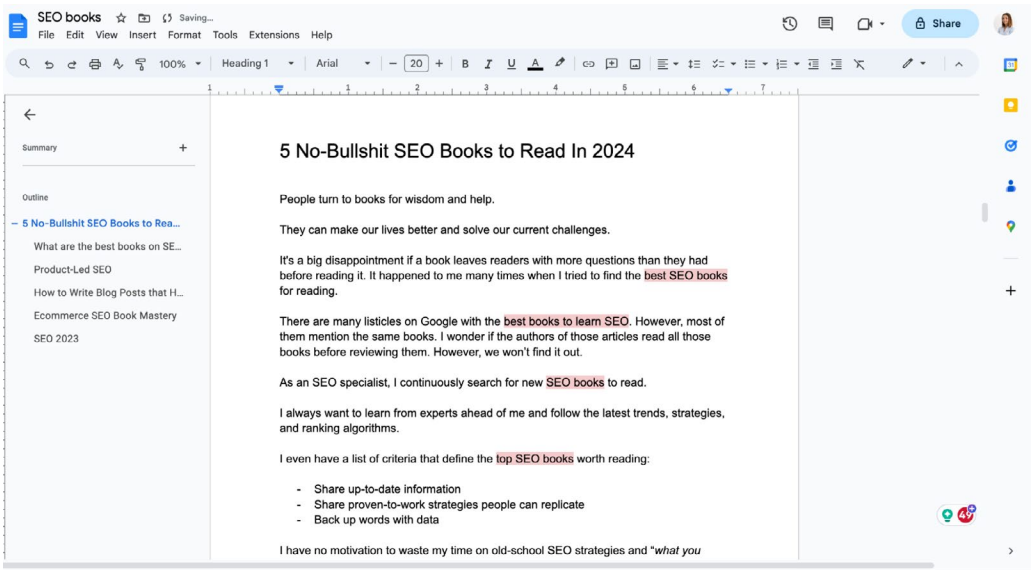
- Add a clickable table of contents to help users quickly jump to other paragraphs. Furthermore, it's a great place to insert your target keywords.

- Highlight keywords in a draft for better visibility.

The screenshot below shows where I inserted keywords for the "SEO books" article.

The introduction also communicates why readers should spend time reading my article and why they can trust me.

I regularly review the keywords in this article and update content to maintain top-ranking positions. That's one of the reasons this article has ranked in the top 10 organic search results, besides smart on-page optimization.



The introduction section of one of my articles.

4. Optimize subheadings such as H2, H3, H4

Like the H1 title tag, subheadings help structure your content, improve readability, and contextually separate different topics within the same article.

Well-structured content helps your readers quickly find what they're looking for.

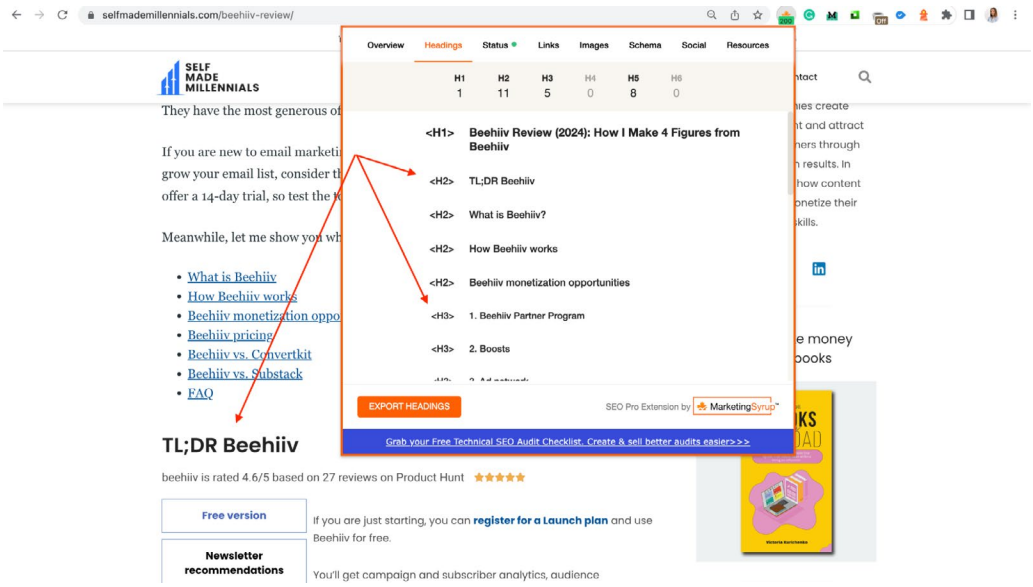
I recommend using the following strategy to optimize subheadings:

- Include 3 to 5 H2 subheadings in long-form content.
- Use H3 subheadings inside H2. It helps visualize the content hierarchy.
- Use semantically related keywords in subheadings.

You can see one of my top-performing articles based on organic performance and affiliate income in the screenshot below. This article has made me over $3.5k in affiliate income because it has ranked in the top 10 for a long time.

In December 2023, it ranked on the second Google search result page because the first page was full of Beehiiv's branded search results.

The screenshot below shows some of the article's headings, where almost each heading is a semantically related keyword or a frequently asked question. I collected many popular questions about Beehiiv and turned my answers into the Beehiiv review blog post.



Examples of subheadings with semantically related keywords on my website.

5. Optimize the body of your article

Neither Google nor SEO experts provide a set of rules on how many keywords your article should contain and the frequency of their usage.

I read a lot of controversial statements about keyword placement but eventually had to figure out how to do it on my own.

Google says it doesn't matter how many keywords you include in the article. At the end of the day, the topical relevance and users' online behavior are what determine the success of your content performance in organic search results.

I agree that covering the topic holistically is important, but I also believe that semantically related keywords can help you achieve it! That's why it's essential to research them before writing your content piece.

Whenever I write optimized content, I include 1–2 semantically related keywords every 300 words.

You're good to go as long as you use your keywords naturally and don't overspam your content with keywords.

Note that copying someone else's content and presenting it as your own won't help you achieve high rankings either.

Google is good at discovering duplicate content. It won't favor your piece if you partially or fully copy it from elsewhere.

As discussed in the previous chapter, create unique and helpful content that includes your opinion and experience. Your thoughts, life lessons, learnings, and experiences are unique! Therefore, no one can write the same way you do!

Be bold and keep experimenting.

After all, SEO is about experiments, wins, failures, and learnings.

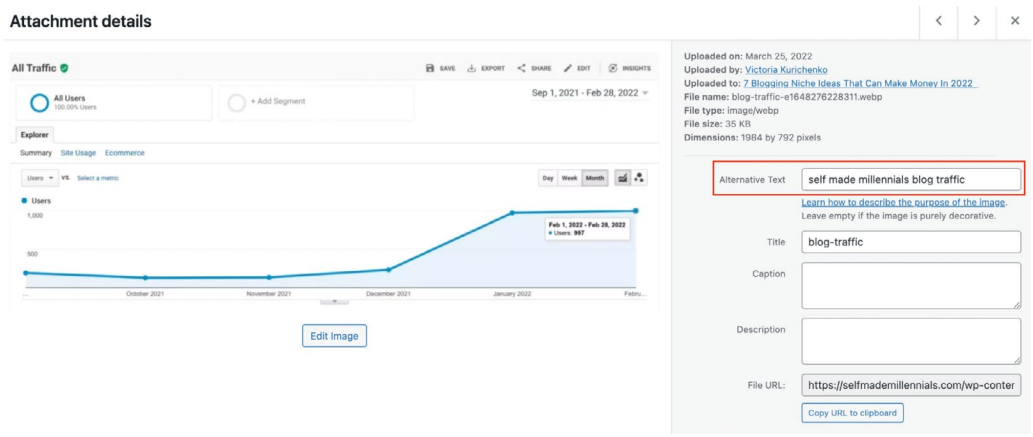
6. Optimize images

Images, tables, graphs, and infographics improve readability and help break long blocks of text. Therefore, I recommend adding a few pictures to your content.

However, Google cannot see and understand images just yet. For this reason, they've introduced an **alt tag**. It describes images to search engine bots and readers with visual impairment.

Using the WordPress content management system, you can add alternative text after uploading a new image (see my example below).

If you use custom code or run your website in Webflow, you must manually add **<img alt="text">** tag or ask a developer for help.



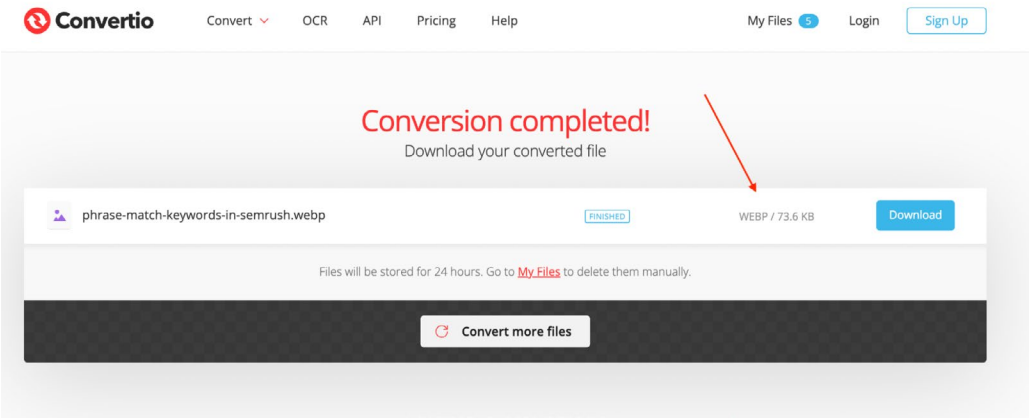
How to manually add an alt tag to the image. Source: WordPress.

I also recommended reducing the image size before uploading it to your website. This way, your image will occupy less space and won't slow down the page loading speed.

The preferred image format for WordPress and other content management systems is WebP. It is a modern image format designed to make web pages load faster.

I use WebP image formatting all over my website to reduce the page loading speed.

For example, one PNG image weighs 314 KB. However, its size will be reduced to 73.6 KB after converting it to the WebP format. That's a big difference, especially if your web page has many images.



How to convert PNG images to WebP. Source: Convertio.

7. Optimize the URL

Optimizing URLs is very important for users and Google!

Users prefer navigating to a web page with a readable URL slug rather than one containing ? *, &, numbers, and other signs.

As an SEO expert, I recommend keeping URLs short and inserting your target keywords like this:

✗ yourwebsite.com/index.php?id_sezione=360&sid=3a5ebc944f41d

✓ yourwebsite.com/seo-books/

You should not change the URL once you publish a web page!

If you make changes, the previous URL will continue existing, but it will show a 404 error, which means *"page not found."*

Therefore, **I do not** recommend using the following elements in the URLs:

- Years (2023, 2024)
- Numbers (in case of a listicle)

If excluded, you can update the content of your articles and titles without making the URLs obsolete.

8. Use internal links

Internal linking is how you link from one page to another within your website.

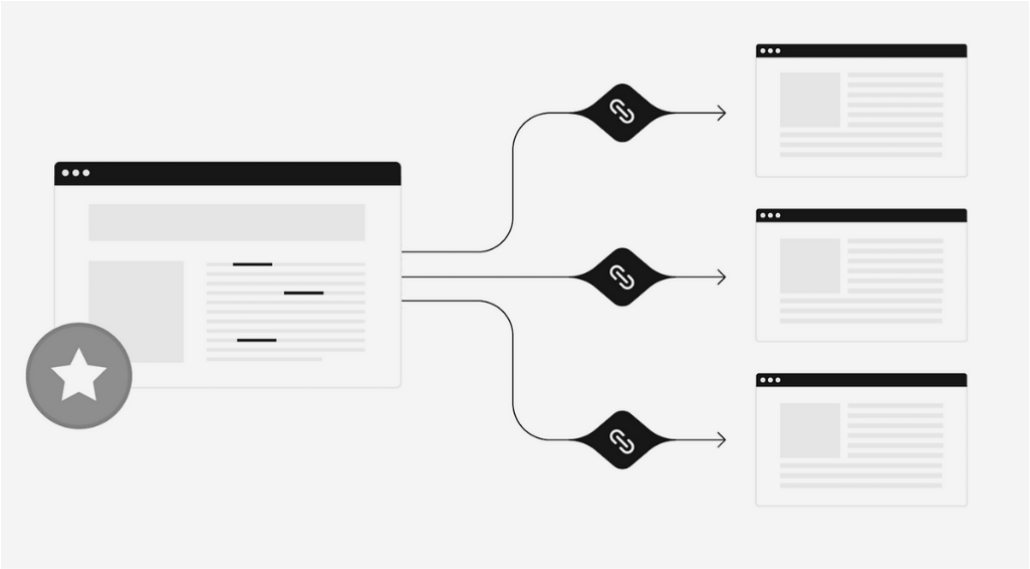
A smart internal linking strategy can help you achieve the following:

- **Increase page views.** Users will navigate from one page to another.
- **Improve indexability.** Google will discover new pages faster.
- **Pass Page Rank** to pages with low authority.

I recommend linking from high-authority pages on your website to those that underperform and need a boost on search. The following are “high-authority” pages on your website:

- Category pages
- Pages with the most backlinks
- Top-performing pages by traffic

Here is what it looks like in practice:



The graph shows how one authority web page passes Page Rank to web pages with lower authority via internal linking.

The chapter recap

I've mentioned a lot of on-page optimization strategies in the previous paragraphs. Can you recall some?

I know it's challenging to remember everything, especially if these strategies are new to you. That's why I created this checklist, which you can use whenever optimizing your content for rankings.

- Include your target keyword in the H1 title tag
- Include your target keyword in the meta title.
- Include your target keyword and/or semantically related keywords in the meta description.
- Include your target keyword and 1–2 semantically related keywords in the first 300 words of your article.
- Use the H1 title tag and H2, H3, and H4 headings to structure your article.
- Include semantically related keywords in subheadings.
- Include 1–2 semantically related keywords in every 300 words in the body of your article

- Use “alt tag” for image description, where you can include your target and/or semantically related keywords.
- Optimize the URL.
- Link from high-authority pages on your website to pages that need a boost.

I recommend focusing on the points mentioned above because those are the primary important things.

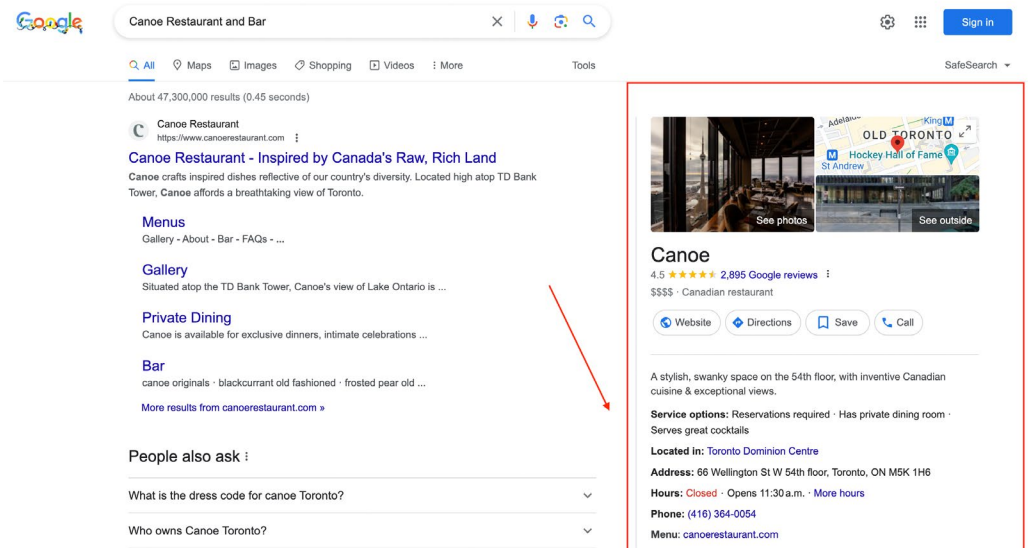
Doing less won’t help you reach the desired results. However, focusing on too many things at once can slow the process.

Besides optimizing your written content, you can add structured data to your website to help your content stand out in organic search results and attract more traffic.

Rich snippets as a way to increase organic CTR

A structured snippet is a piece of structured data that can be added to a website to provide search engines with additional information about your content.

For example, a restaurant might add structured data to its website to indicate its hours of operation, cuisine type, and average price range. Search engines can then display this information in the SERPs, making it easier for users to find relevant restaurants.



Rich snippet for a local restaurant in organic search results. Source: Google.

Rich snippets can be a powerful way to improve the visibility and ranking of your website in organic search results. By providing accurate and relevant data, your website can attract more organic traffic and increase the organic click-through rate (CTR).

Based on my experience, the following rich snippets positively impact CTR and can help attract more visitors to your website.

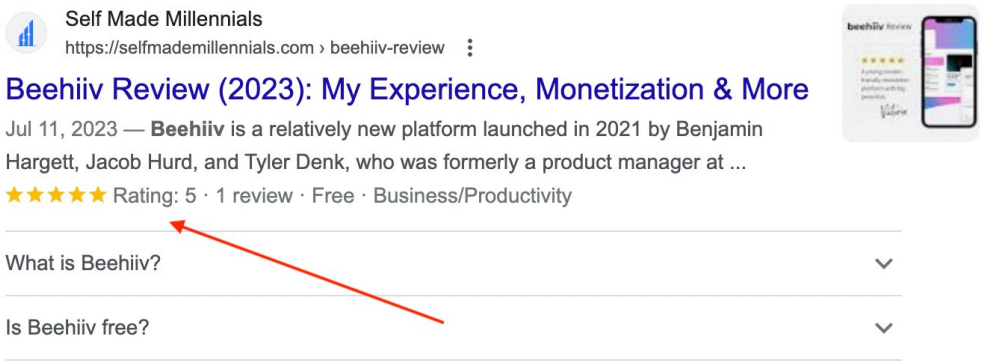
1. FAQ snippet

A frequently asked question (FAQ) snippet shows a list of questions and answers under the title and description of your page.

You can get FAQ snippets if you have a landing page or a blog post with frequently asked questions and answers.

Even though Google says it will only display FAQ snippets for authoritative governmental and health websites, I often see it in search results for regular websites.

Here's what an FAQ-rich snippet looks like in organic search results. Compared to traditional websites, it occupies more space, which makes it more noticeable for users.



Example of an FAQ snippet in search results. Source: Google

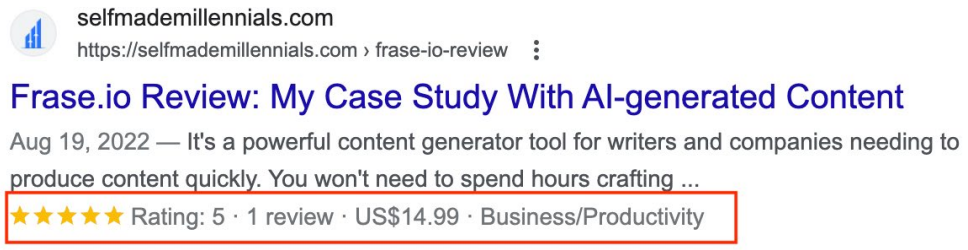
2. Review snippet

This type of rich snippet is designed to help users get a quick overview of a product or service's overall sentiment and quality based on public reviews.

I actively use this type of rich snippet when writing product reviews.

If implemented correctly, Google picks it up almost immediately and shows it next to your search result.

A review snippet is an excellent way to help your web pages stand out.



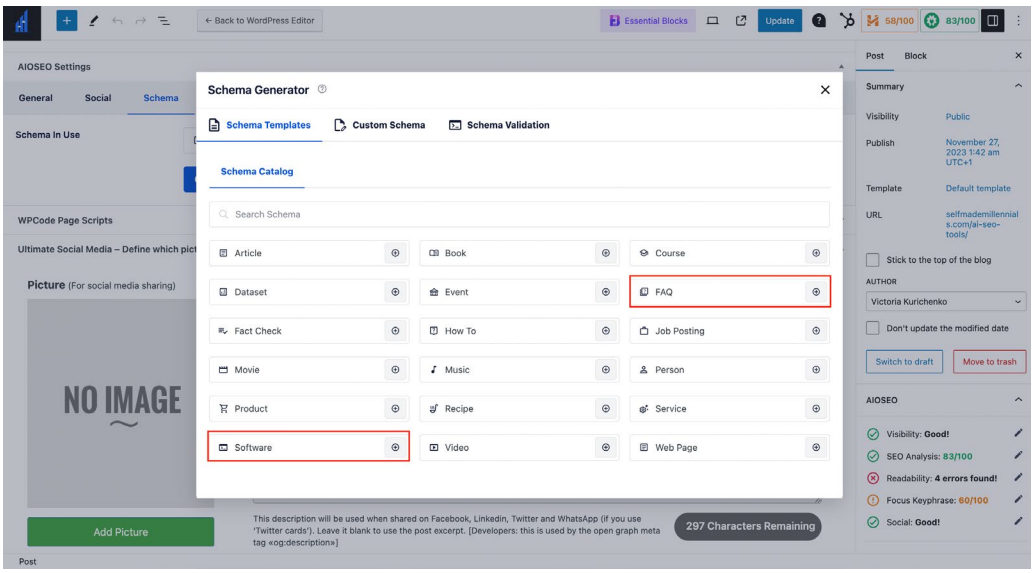
Example of review snippet in search results. Source: Google.

I've only shown you a few examples that work well for blog posts. However, there are more types of rich snippets that you can implement:

- **Product Information:** Prices, availability, and ratings for products.
- **Events:** Date, time, and location information for upcoming events.
- **Recipes:** Cooking time, calories, and user ratings for recipes.
- **Video Thumbnails:** Thumbnails from videos, along with video duration.
- **Local Business Information:** Address, phone number, business hours, and location on a map.

To implement rich snippets, you must add structured data markup to your web pages. However, many plugins for content management systems let you do it without coding.

For example, I use the All-in-One SEO Pro plugin for WordPress websites. The plugin provides easy-to-understand and use functionality to add rich snippets. All I have to do is pick the desired rich snippet type and insert the content.



How to add rich snippets to your web pages in WordPress. Source: All-in-One SEO Pro plugin.

3 ways to use AI for content writing without hurting your website

You already know that creating AI-generated content to manipulate organic search results violates Google policies. Such websites may drastically lose rankings or be entirely removed from organic search results.

So, playing with Google is risky.

However, there are ways to use AI for content writing safely.

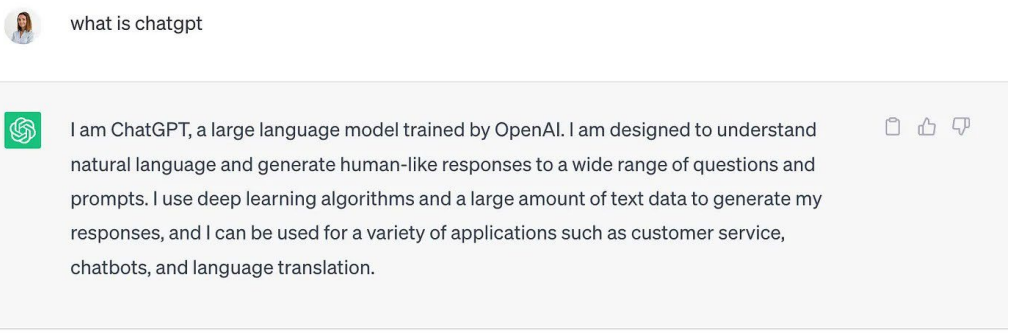
You can use the following prompts to speed up your writing and create high-ranking content. They also work well for ChatGPT and Bard!

1. “What is [topic]?”

If you struggle to write clear and succinct definitions, try this prompt.

Based on my experience, AI tools like Bard and ChatGPT provide great ideas for definitions.

Feel free to copy and edit them before using them.



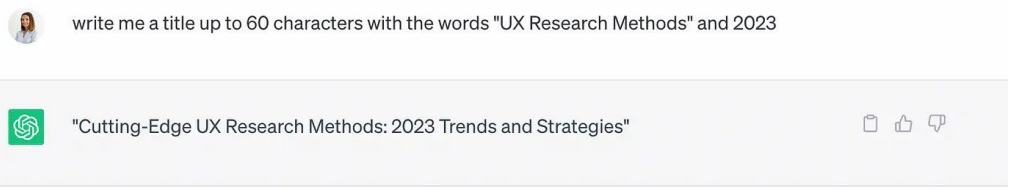
How to use AI tools to generate definitions. Source: ChatGPT.

2. “Write me a title of up to 60 characters with the [keyword]

ChatGPT can create meta titles and descriptions based on your requirements.

It also understands queries like "make it shorter" or "make it more catchy."

If you run out of ideas for metadata, use ChatGPT and Bard. It's absolutely safe for your website. You won't get any penalty from Google if you use AI tools for this purpose.

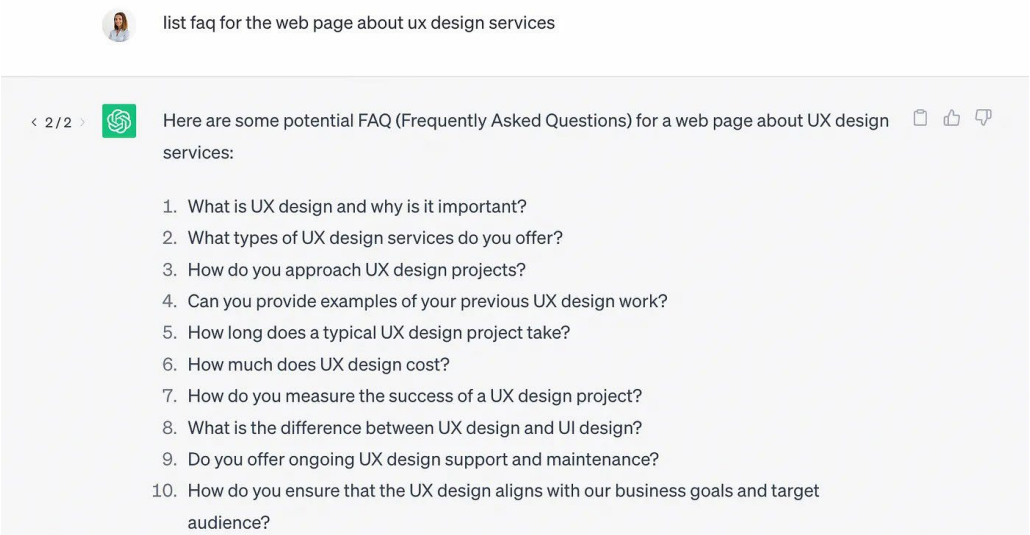


How to use AI tools to generate meta titles. Source: ChatGPT.

3. “List FAQ for the web page about [topic]”

If you want to include an FAQ section in your article but don’t know what it should cover, use AI tools for ideas generation.

Based on my experience, AI tools are pretty good at generating frequently asked questions on a given topic.



How to use AI tools to generate frequently asked questions. Source: ChatGPT.

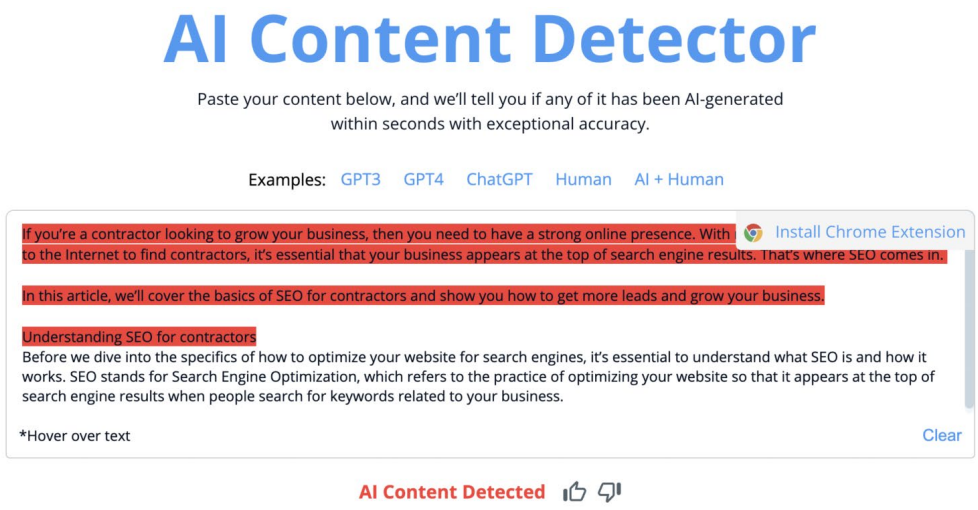
I've discovered a few more things while using ChatGPT as a content-generation tool.

Regardless of what people say, ChatGPT can’t do keyword research instead of you. It can’t measure keyword difficulty and search volumes. Instead of semantically related keywords, ChatGPT lists broad topics. However, it doesn’t mean they are all related to your target keyword and should be used in your article.

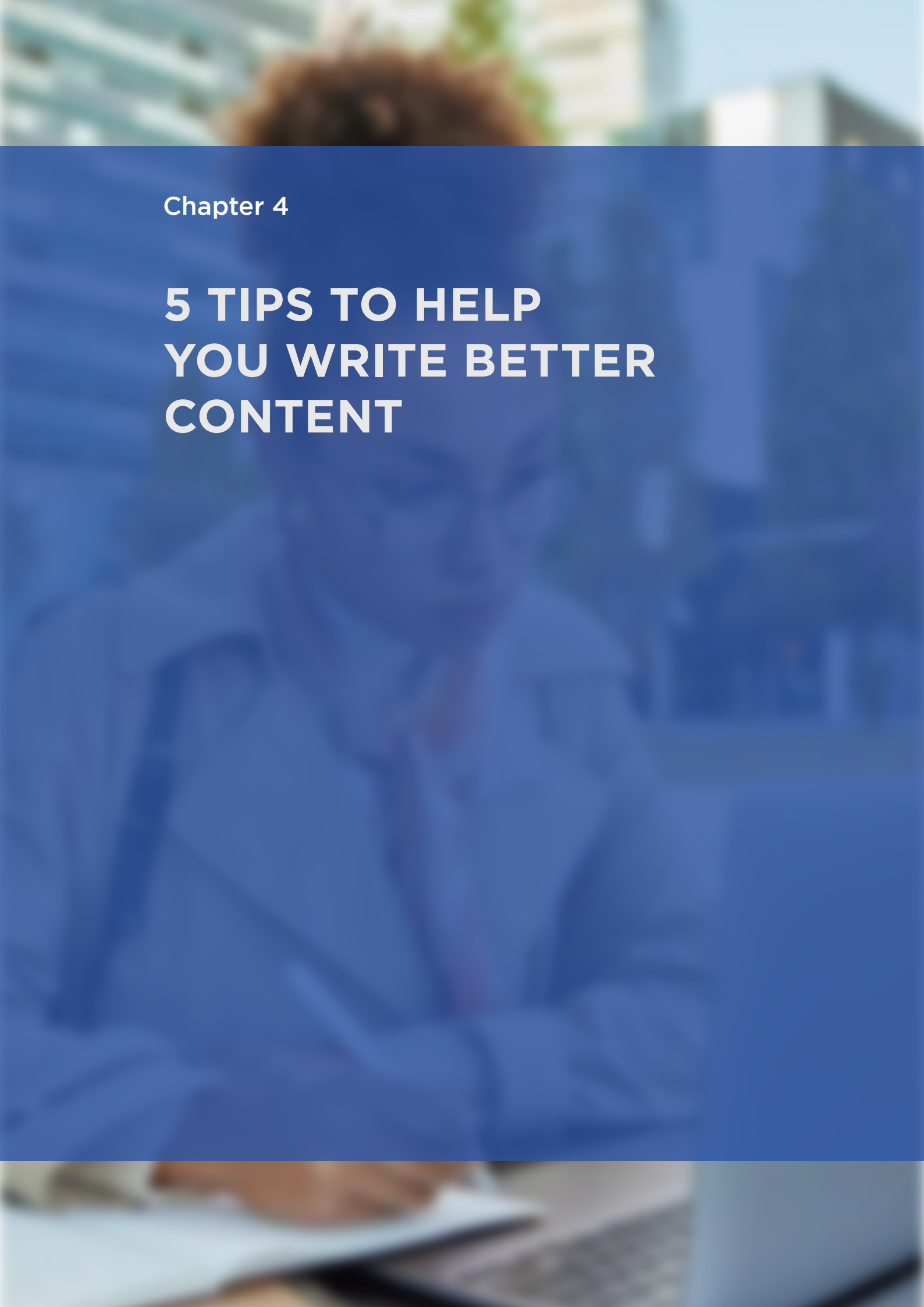
I’ve already mentioned using Semrush for keyword research since it has all the essential reports for in-depth keyword research and analysis. I shared a list of recommended tools for keyword research in

chapter 7. So, you can pick a tool that suits your goals and budget.

Secondly, ChatGPT produces content that AI detectors flag as AI-generated. Remember that if you use AI tools for writing, anyone can easily check it.



AI tools can detect AI-generated content. Source: Copyleaks.



Chapter 4

5 TIPS TO HELP YOU WRITE BETTER CONTENT

Let’s be honest: writing is challenging.

Even though everyone can create content, only experienced writers can follow your tone of voice, optimize your content to rank in organic search results, and promote your products and services through content.

Writing is an art, in a way.

The good news is that you can improve your writing skills by following the writing principles and tips from experienced content creators.

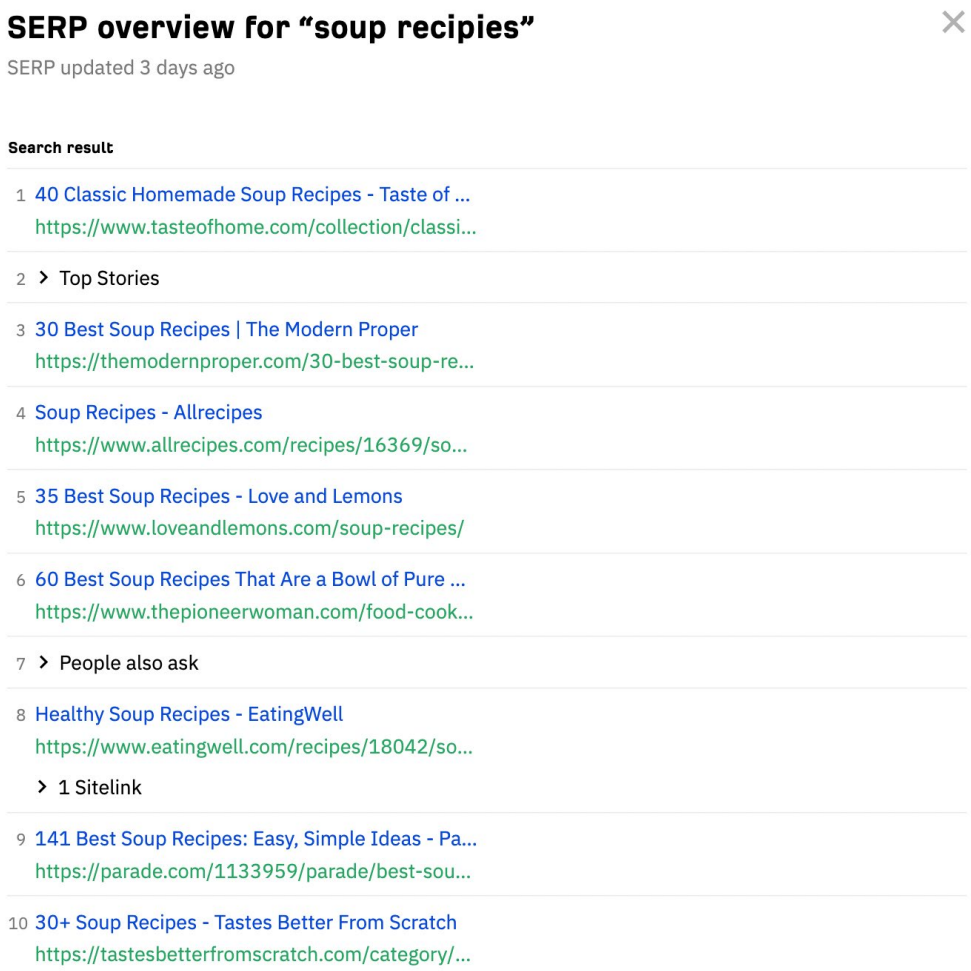
As an SEO expert and content writer, I strive to help you create content with the best chance of ranking on the first search result page.

Here’s how you can improve your writing and attract your target audience.

1. Create a unique angle for your content

Imagine you live in the United States and search for the "*soup recipes*."

You'll likely see the following search results:



Search results for "soup recipes" in the USA. Source: Ahrefs.

The first 10 search results are similar, which makes it difficult to choose just one website.

As a user, you probably don't know what makes one search result better than another.

Since none of the meta titles stand out, you'll likely open websites one by one.

Can you relate to it?

This is how many users behave when searching for anything online.

Why? Because meta titles don't stand out!

They are all the same and don't attract users' attention.

As a website owner, your goal is to get users to choose your website over all others. That's why you must develop a unique content angle that will differentiate you from competitors.

A content piece without a unique angle is like another fish in the big ocean called the Internet. It is technically there, but no one cares. It doesn't attract attention.

What if any of those websites had the following meta title:

Easy-To-Make Soup Recipes (By Chef) 2024 Cookbook

What would you say about this meta title? Would you click?

I'd probably click because this content piece has a unique angle (soup recipes by chef updated for 2024) that distinguishes it from other articles in search results.

User experience begins on the search result page before anyone lands on your site. Over 10 websites compete for users' attention. Therefore, it's essential to optimize the meta title and communicate why your content is worth reading to attract your target audience.

How to create a unique angle for your content

First, analyze the top ten organic search results.

Do most meta titles have numbers, years, and words like “top,” “best,” etc.?

Are those listicles, guides, or checklists?

You can create a unique angle for your content when you understand which websites rank at the top of organic search results.

Consider the following tips while creating a unique angle for your content.

1. Include the author's bio

Many websites don’t mention who creates content for them. Therefore, users don’t know whether the information is reliable and trustworthy.

You can make your content unique by communicating who the author of your content is, whether an expert writes an article, and why users should trust you.

It will help you add a unique angle to your content and align it with Google’s content quality requirements. Refer to the previous chapter for my proven-to-work tips on how to optimize your content for Google’s E-E-A-T requirements.

2. Specify your criteria for product reviews

If you write product or software reviews, specify the criteria you use while reviewing products. People want to know why you recommend particular products and why they are better than anything else.

This recommendation is particularly important for websites that regularly publish product comparisons and reviews to make affiliate commissions.

3. Share your experience

Your content will become more valuable if you describe your experience related to the topic of your article. For example, did you try a product or service before reviewing it?

Sharing your personal experience will add a unique angle to your content and increase its chances of ranking high on Google (according to the latest updates to the content quality raters' guidelines).

4. Include your expert opinion

If you are an expert running a niche website, include your personal and expert opinion in the content. It will immediately differentiate your content from the rest of the search results.

People want to hear from experts and don't want to waste their time. If you know how you can help your target audience solve their challenges, communicate it via your content! It will help your website stand out among competitors.

5. Update your content regularly

Even if you create evergreen content, it will eventually become obsolete. People (and Google) like fresh and valuable content.

If you update your website content yearly, it will have a higher chance of maintaining and improving its ranking positions.

6. Show the impact

Many content creators say what you should do, but you'll rarely find content that shows what you can achieve by doing something. Content that shows the impact (positive or negative) is the most valuable.

If you write educational content, show what people can achieve by following your advice. It will make your articles more insightful and unique.

2. Include links to credible sources

As a content creator, I write, edit, and optimize content for my website and clients' websites daily.

One of the common mistakes I often see writers make is they don't include sources. They mention facts and data in their posts but don't include sources. Which of the two statements below do you find credible?

1. USA citizens spent roughly $800–$900 on Christmas gifts.
2. According to Statista, US citizens spent an average of $923 on Christmas gifts in 2023.

As a reader, I'd say the second statement is credible since it relies on data provided by Statista and indicates the year. It's a great example of a statement you can trust.

If your goal is to make people believe you and your content, you can achieve it by quoting experts and including links to credible external resources.

3. Pay attention to readability

User experience is as important nowadays as content quality. If users find reading and understanding your content difficult, they will leave your website.

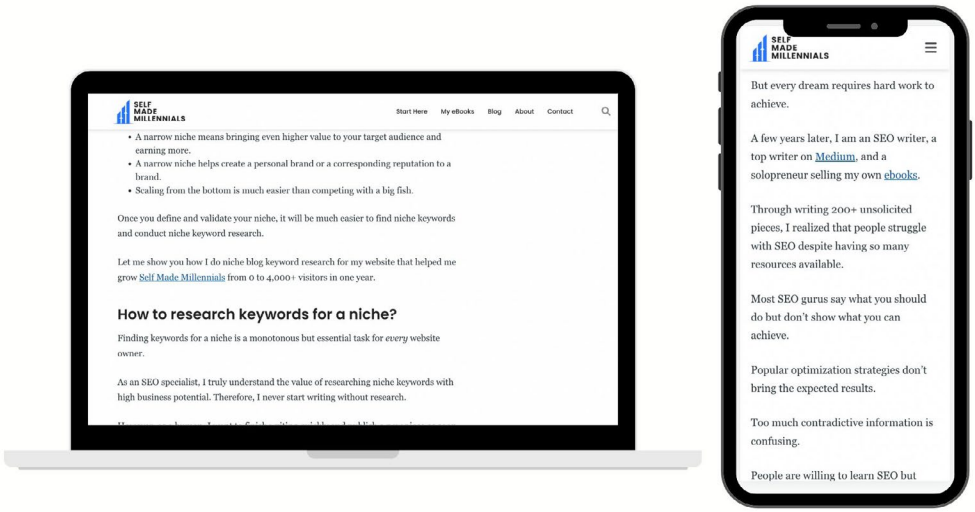
As you already know, Google pays attention to users' online behavior. If your webpage doesn't satisfy users' search intent, Google can push it down in organic search results. Therefore, you should pay attention to the readability of your content.

Too long paragraphs and complex sentences make it challenging to comprehend content, especially on mobile devices.



Example of poor content readability.

You can add extra white space, write short paragraphs, and use simple English to improve your content readability.



Example of good content readability.

4. Use CTAs

The main goal of a call-to-action (CTA) is to encourage your visitors to take a desired action. Whether subscribing to a newsletter, downloading a whitepaper, or making a purchase, CTAs can help you achieve your business goals.

For example, you can use in-text CTAs that are natively embedded in the content. These CTAs don't look like ads. That's why users don't skip them immediately.

Here's what in-text CTAs look like in one of my blog posts.

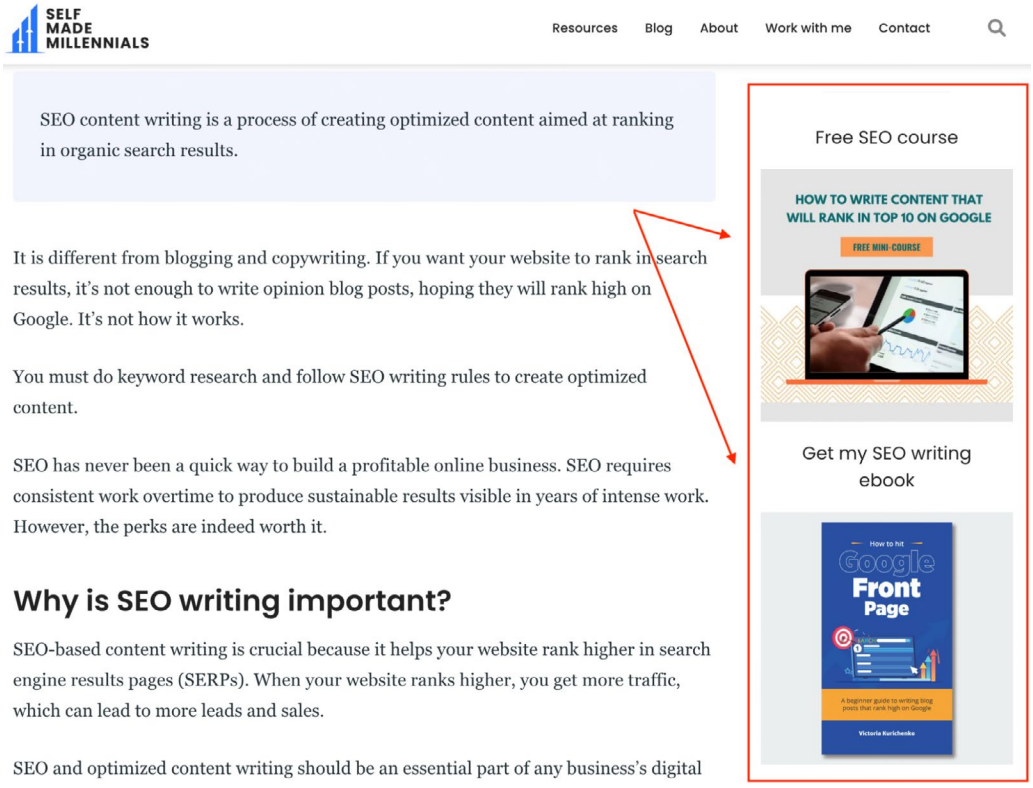
> Even though Robinize is still in its early growth stage, it can help optimize your content for rankings. Moreover, Robinize has a free version with 3 free monthly reports and a ChatGPT integration. If you are looking for a free or affordable AI SEO tool, register and try Robinize.

An example of a CTA usage in one of my blog posts. Source: Self Made Millennials website.

You can use in-text CTAs multiple times in one content piece to promote various offers. If you can clearly communicate the value of your offers, users will eagerly click on your CTAs.

Besides in-text CTAs, you can also use banners.

For example, I use banners to promote my digital products and seasonal offers from various brands. Almost every page on my website features my ebook, which makes my site the third-best sales generation channel.



Examples of banner CTAs on my website.

Take the most out of your content by including CTAs. Here are a few principles that will help you write effective CTAs:

Clarity and conciseness: Keep CTAs short, direct, and easy to understand. Avoid ambiguity or lengthy explanations.

Strong action verbs: Employ powerful action verbs that inspire action, such as "Learn More," "Sign Up," or "Shop Now."

Make CTAs visually appealing: Your CTAs must stand out from the surrounding content. Use contrasting colors, bold fonts, and clear call-to-action buttons.

Positioning: Strategically place CTAs where they are most likely to be noticed and clicked. For example, consider placing CTAs in sidebars or below key content sections.

5. Include success stories

I've published over 300 articles on my Medium blog and website before realizing that **success stories sell!**

If you publicly share your professional struggles, you'll see they resonate with your target audience because they've been through similar struggles, too. That's why your target audience will definitely want to know how you overcome your challenges and whether your solutions will work for them. It's a fantastic opportunity to turn your readers into fans and sell your products.

This is the end of this chapter.

I sincerely hope my writing tips were helpful and taught you something new. Apply them in practice and see how they work for you.

In the next chapter, I'll teach you how to improve your rankings if your website was affected by Google algorithm updates.



Chapter 5

WHAT TO DO IF YOUR WEBSITE RANKINGS DROP

Managing a website is a challenging endeavor full of ups and downs.

You may experience sudden traffic and impressions growth even without implementing any changes. However, you may also see your website losing rankings due to competitors outperforming your website or due to sudden Google updates.

I know it’s painful.

However, every website owner goes through this from time to time.

Even though my website hasn’t experienced significant traffic drops, I had to update the content of the money-making pages to maintain rankings and boost organic traffic where possible.

As you might have already guessed, I’m introducing you to a proven-to-work strategy you can implement at any time to improve your website performance — content update.

Content update is the process of updating the existing content of your web pages by removing old and adding new content. It is essential to do it for evergreen and time-sensitive content for several reasons.

First, users want to consume fresh content only. No one wants to read old guides, tips, and strategies that no longer work. It is a waste of time!

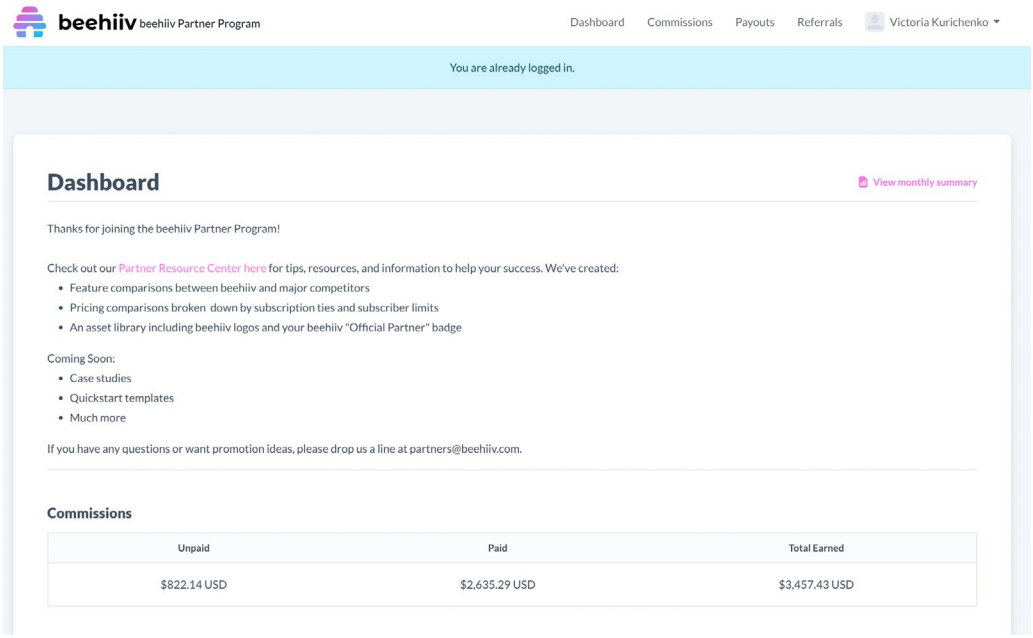
Secondly, you already know that Google tracks users' online behavior and boosts web pages that satisfy users’ search intent.

And last but not least, your competitors will always want to outperform you in organic search results. If you don’t implement changes on your website, someone else will sooner or later outperform you in organic search results.

That’s why you must update your top-performing website pages regularly.

Let me show you how the performance of my top money-making article changed after the content update.

The Beehiiv review made me over $3,457.43 in affiliate income in 2023. It’s a pretty high affiliate commission generated by one article.



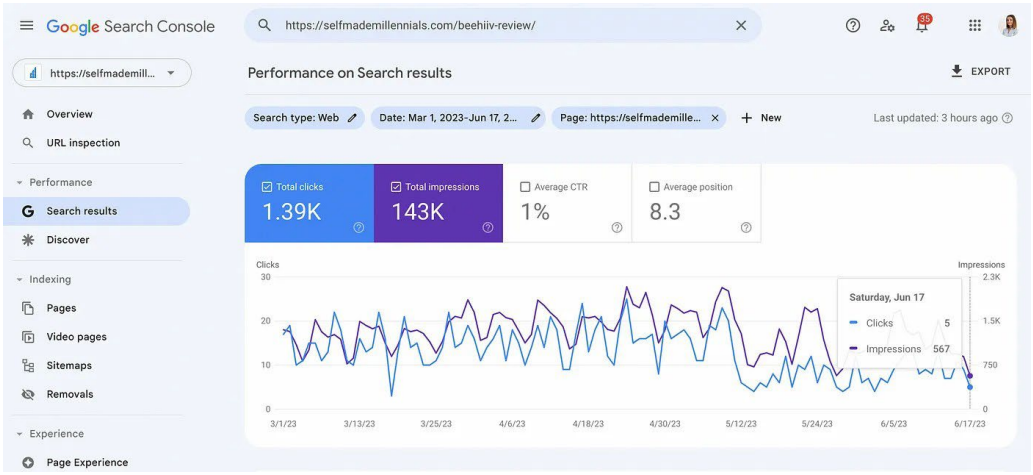
I’ve made $3,457.43 from the Beehiiv review in 2023 as an affiliate income. Source: Beehiiv Partner Program Dashboard.

I wasn’t the only one targeting this keyword. The competition has intensified since many website owners wanted to rank their pages in the top ten organic search results.

Even though my article ranked high for over 6 months, its performance declined:

- Impressions dropped.

- Clicks dropped from 20–30 to 2–5 per day.
- Rankings dropped to the third Google search result page.
- I did not get new referrals in May and June 2023.



Here's what happens if you don't update your website content for a long time. Source: Google Search Console.

It was time to act.

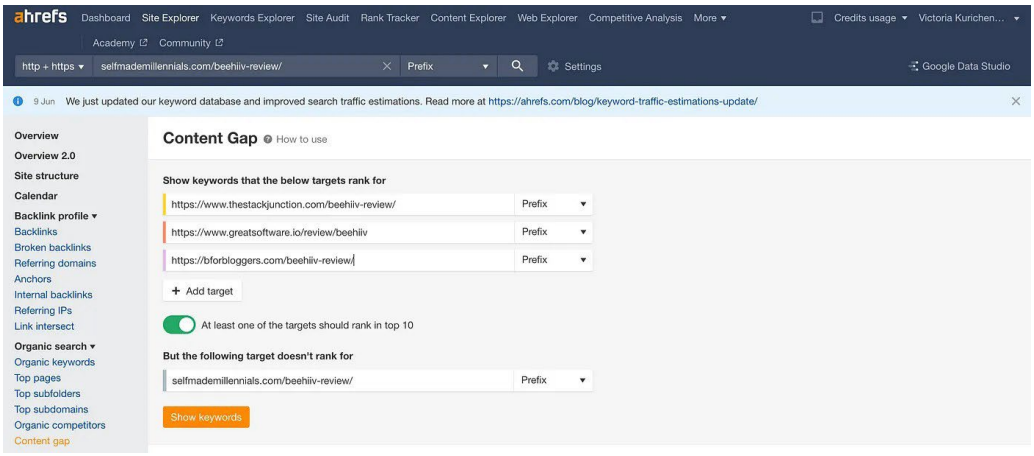
Here's what I've done step-by-step to bring my article back to the top positions in organic search results.

1. I compared my article to the top-performing competitors

My article has ranked among the top five organic search results for a while, but it suddenly lost its position on Google. I wondered what competitors did and what keywords they ranked for to outperform my article.

That's why I did a quick content gap analysis in Ahrefs to collect keywords the competitor web pages ranked for, but my article did not.

FYI, Semrush has a similar feature called “Keyword Gap.”



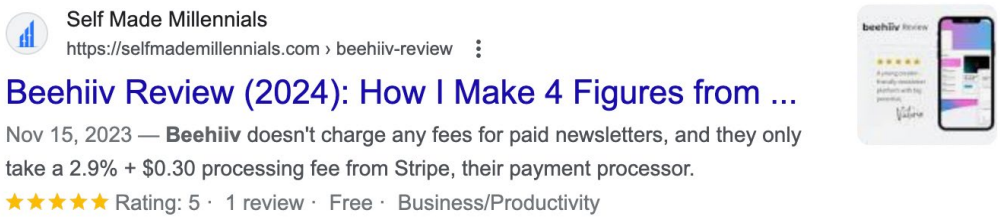
How to conduct content gap analysis. Source: Ahrefs.

2. I rewrote the meta title and meta description

I constantly analyze the meta titles of the top-performing web pages to craft a more appealing meta title for my web page.

You already know that users quickly assess the top 10 organic search results before choosing where to click. More appealing or even clickbait meta titles attract more users from organic search results and increase click-through rate (CTR).

Here is what my up-to-date Beehiiv’s meta title and description look like.



My article’s meta title and description preview.

Right after the content update, the article jumped back to the top 5 positions on Google (more about it later), so I collected the CTR stats a week after the new version of the article was published.

The "Beehiiv review" keyword had the best CTR — 5.71%. That's because my meta title contained the exact match keyword, and the article answered users' search intent.

However, the CTR was much lower for the "Beehiiv" keyword since the search intent for this keyword is mixed. We don't know what users want by searching for this keyword. I assume most of them type this keyword whenever they wish to navigate to the Beehiiv main page. Therefore, shoehorning the review article doesn't work.

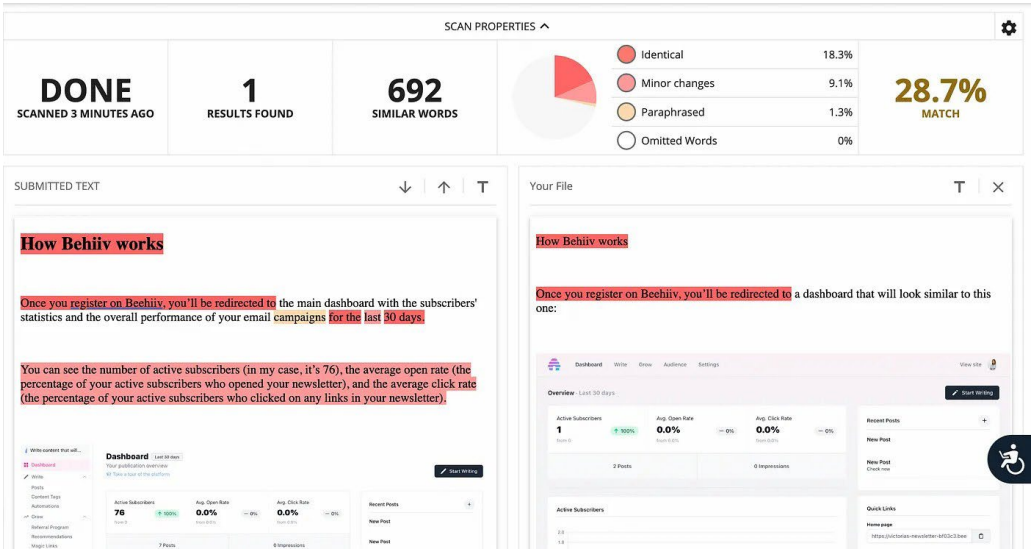
Top queries	Clicks	Impressions	CTR	Position
beehiiv	22	8018	0.27%	5.72
beehiv	7	1952	0.36%	3.89
beehive newsletter	7	1884	0.37%	3.26
beehive email	1	332	0.30%	3.78
beehiiv pricing	2	212	0.94%	5.12
beehivv	1	185	0.54%	4.87
beehiiv newsletter	1	140	0.71%	4.26
beehiv newsletter	2	129	1.55%	3.12
beehiiv review	6	105	5.71%	3.74

Top performing queries vs. their CTR.

3. Updated over 70% of content

Since I'm an avid user of the Beehiiv email software, I knew about the pros and cons of Beehiiv and monetization opportunities for content creators. That's why I only spent a few hours rewriting the article and optimizing it for rankings.

Eventually, I rewrote over 70% of the original content.



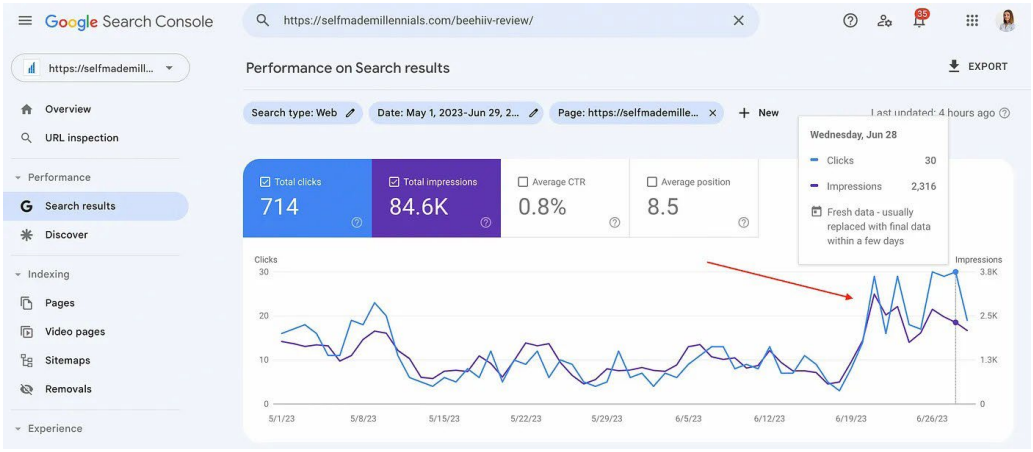
I updated over 70% of my Beehiiv review. Source: Copyleaks.

How the article's performance changed

I spent one day analyzing, rewriting, and optimizing the article. The updated version was released on the 20th of June, 2023.

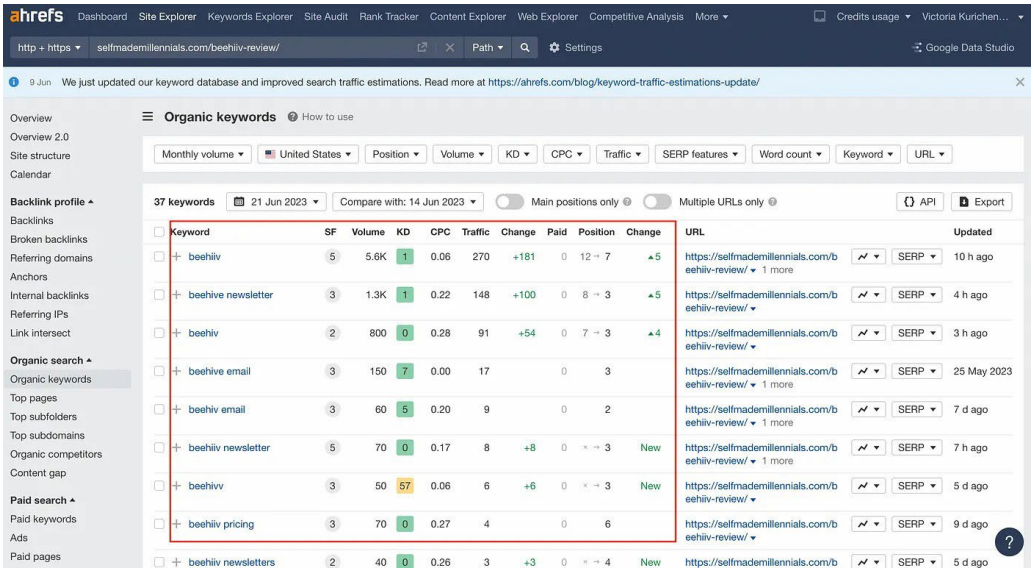
Here is how the article's performance changed:

- Impressions tripled.
- The number of clicks changed from 2–5 to roughly 20–30 per day.
- The article returned to the top 5 search engine results for the "beehiiv" keyword and more.
- The article started ranking for new keywords, like "beehiiv newsletter" and "beehiiv pricing."
- I've got two new referrals within two weeks after the content update.



How Beehiiv's article's performance changed after republishing it. Source: Google Search Console.

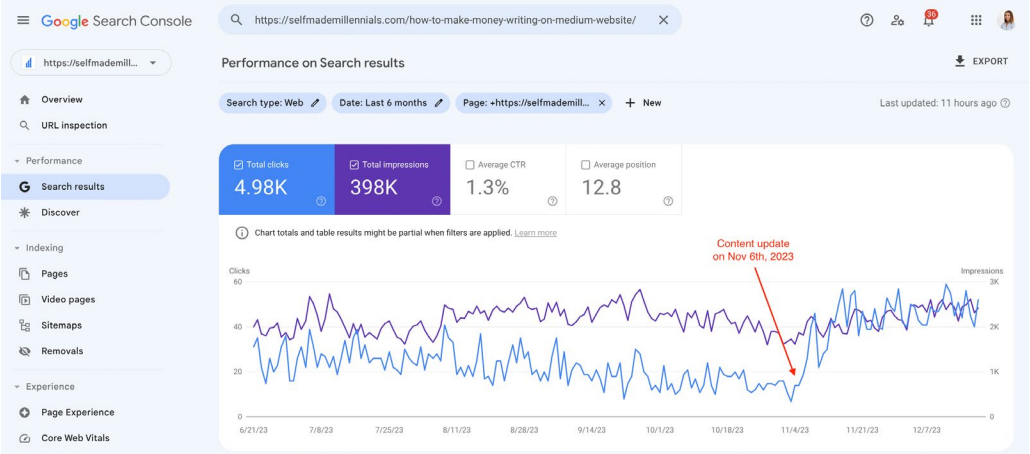
After republishing the article, you can also see how rankings for the target keywords improved.



As a result of the content update, the ranking positions improved for the target keywords. Moreover, the article started ranking for more related keywords.

Based on my experience, the content update strategy works for every website regardless of its niche. It's not a one-time success story. I've seen many examples proving that impressions and traffic immediately grow a few days after publishing updated content.

For example, you can see the performance of one of my oldest blog posts below. I updated its content twice at the end of 2022 and 2023 years. You can see how its organic performance improved after the last content update.



Example 1: How my Medium review performance improved after rewriting 50% of the content.

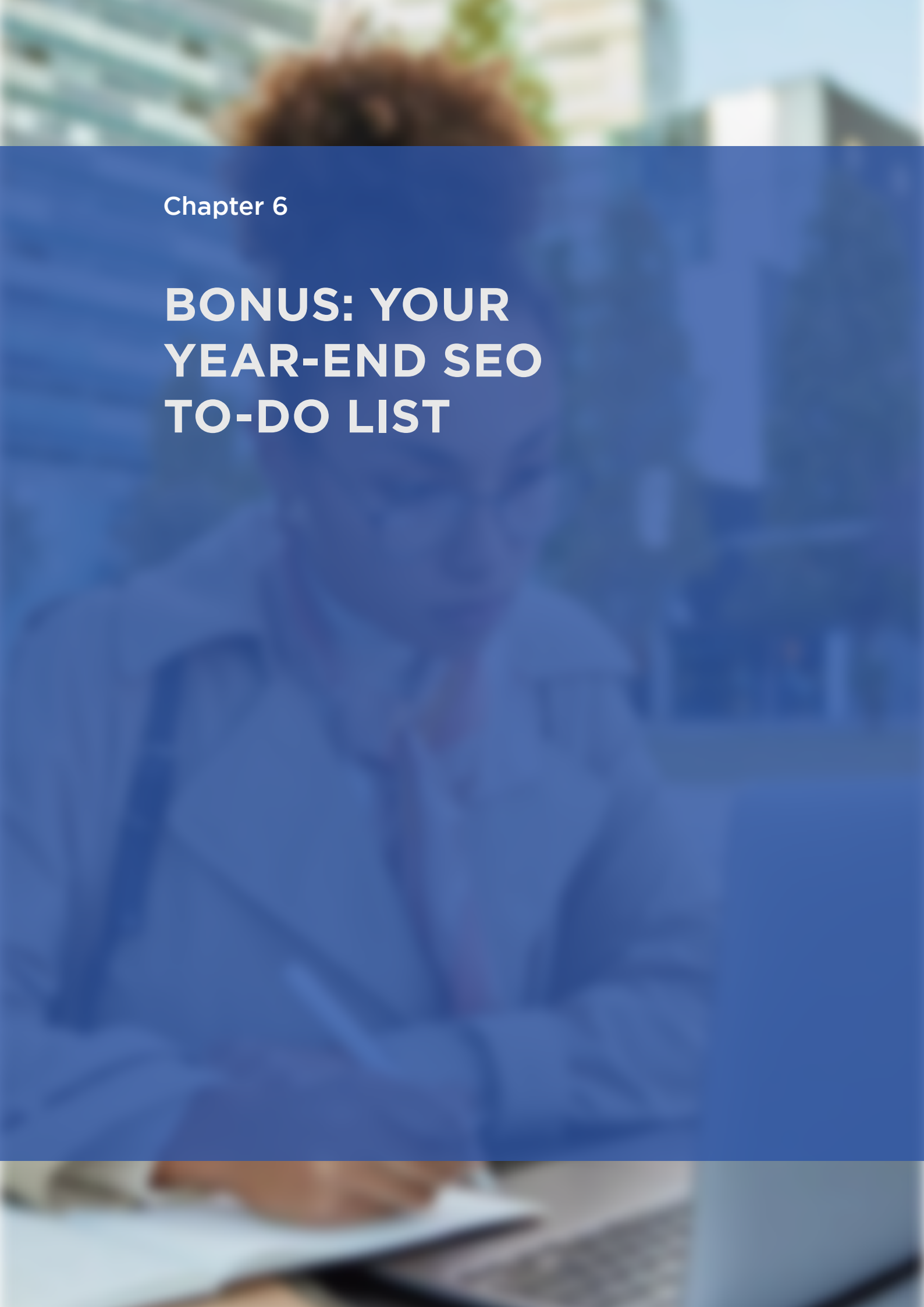
What conclusion can we draw from this experiment?

Content update works!

It's one of the most underrated SEO strategies. Nevertheless, giving the content a second life requires research, analysis, and writing skills.

It's worth mentioning that I did not do any link-building in the example above. The performance improvement was achieved solely by updating old content.

I recommend updating your money-making pages at least once a year. It will help you improve the rankings of your most essential website pages on the first Google search result page.



Chapter 6

BONUS: YOUR YEAR-END SEO TO-DO LIST

Since this is a practical SEO ebook, I want to share one more proven-to-work process I've developed for my website and client websites.

It's a year-end SEO to-do list.

In a nutshell, it's an ordered list of tasks you should implement on your website at the end of each year (around November) to achieve the following goals:

- **Maintain your website rankings.** If you don't regularly work on your existing content, competitors can easily outperform your website.

- **Boost organic traffic.** You can improve the performance of your website and generate more organic traffic without publishing new pages.

So, if you hold this ebook in November, December, or even January, it's the right time to think about the year-end website review. Although these strategies are beneficial if implemented at the end of the year, you can use them to review your website anytime.

1. Define money-making pages

Money-making pages can help you make money from your website. These could be well-performing service pages or product pages.

These pages are essential for your business. Your goal should be to improve their rankings and create more similar pages in the future.

In my case, the Pareto principle works well for my website: 80% of income is generated by 20% of pages. Therefore, I continuously pay attention to these pages.

2. Check how your money-making pages perform

Ask yourself the following questions while analyzing your money-making pages:

- Did your pages gain or lose ranking positions over the past year?
- Did your organic traffic increase or decrease?
- Did your earnings decrease or increase?
- Have you noticed any new competitors outranking your web pages in organic search results?

If your money-making pages' performance has worsened over the past 6 months, it's time to improve your content and on-page optimization strategies.

3. Create a content update list

I recommend creating a list of pages that you are planning to work on in the future. This will be particularly helpful for medium and big websites since you might end up with hundreds of pages that require a content update.

4. Prioritize web pages based on their business value

If you have over 10 pages to update, you must know how to prioritize your work.

I recommend prioritizing web pages based on their business value. In other words, the best money-making pages should be updated first. This way, you'll continue making money or generating leads even if your website loses rankings in organic search results.

5. Update meta titles and meta descriptions

If you still have “2023” in the meta titles, users won’t even click on your web pages in organic search results.

Users will also ignore your webpage if its meta title and description are similar to the rest of the search results. Why? Because they don't know why your page is different or better than anything else in the top 10 search results.

That’s why the metadata must be catchy and up-to-date for your money-making pages. Chapter 3 of this ebook, “How to optimize meta title and meta description,” provides a step-by-step guide on metadata creation.

6. Update at least 50% of the content

Google treats a web page as original if at least 50% of its content is unique. It means your web page should have at least 50% unique, human-written, preferably and helpful content to rank in organic search results. It is the result of a study conducted by the Page Optimization Agency.

After updating over 30 web pages on different websites, I realized you’d see a noticeable improvement in 2–3 days after updating at least 50% of the content.

7. Optimize content

Optimization is an essential step. Ensure you include the target keywords and semantically related keywords in the updated part of the content.

8. Republish content

I recommend updating the publication date when republishing an existing web page. The new date will be visible in Google over time, which can help users choose your web page among all the rest of the pages.

Ensure you don't change an existing URL slug since it will lead to a 404 error (page not found).

9. Track changes in Google Search Console

It usually takes several days for Google to recrawl your updated web page.

I encourage you to track your website performance in Google Search Console. You'll notice a positive impact of the content update in a couple of days. In particular, you'll see a spike in impressions and clicks.

I assure you these strategies work if implemented correctly. Whenever you are ready to review and update your old content, follow this checklist:

1. Define money-making pages
2. Check how your money-making pages perform
3. Create a content update list
4. Priotitize web pages based on their business value
5. Update meta titles and meta descriptions
6. Update at least 50% of the content
7. Optimize content
8. Publish content
9. Track changes in Google Search Console.

Chapter 7

RECOMMENDED TOOLS

You've reached the final chapter of this ebook. My congratulations!

You already know how to conduct keyword research, analyze search intent, and optimize content to hit the Google front page.

However, you can achieve great results faster if you use the right SEO tools.

As an SEO expert, I've used and reviewed over 50 paid and free SEO tools. You'll find my curated list of SEO tools below. These are SEO and AI tools that I use daily to create content, research keywords, and do on-page SEO work.

Check the list and find the most suitable tools for your business.

1. Semrush

Best for

- Marketers
- SEO experts
- Agencies managing client websites
- Site owners willing to grow their websites

Best features

- On-page SEO Checker
- SEO content template
- Writing assistant

Pricing

- From $129.95

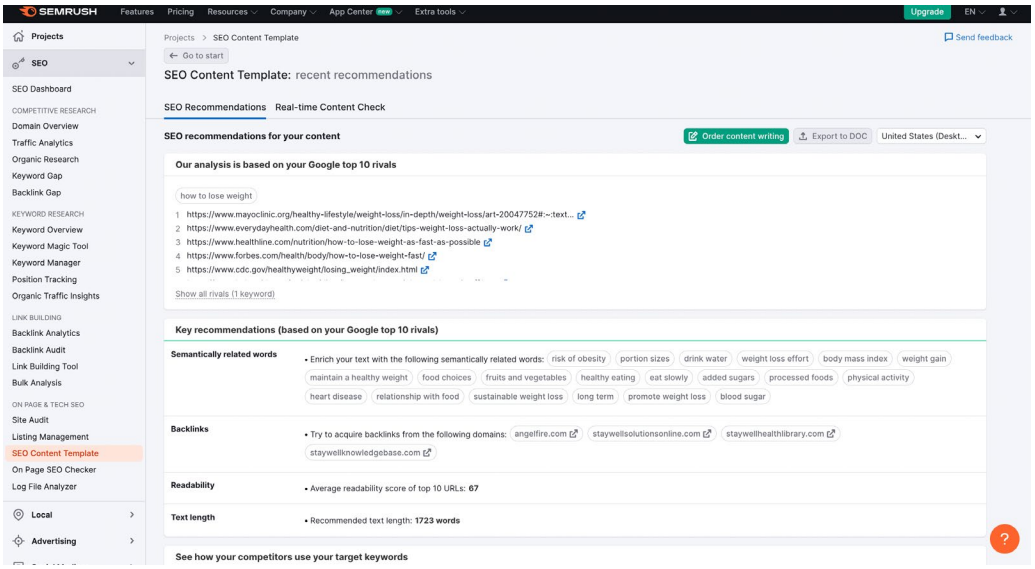
Semrush is an all-in-one digital marketing tool with over 55 features to

help you grow your website.

As an SEO specialist and content writer, I use Semrush to conduct site audits, track my website performance, conduct niche keyword research, and create optimized content.

If your goal is to create optimized content for your website, you can also use Semrush SEO Content Template.

For example, Semrush automatically identifies semantically related keywords, minimum text length, and content optimization opportunities. It's a big-time saver. Besides, it's available under the Semrush free plan. You can try Semrush for free by following this link.



Semrush SEO content template.

2. Frase.io

Best for

- Content creators
- Site owners who write a lot of content

- Freelance content writers

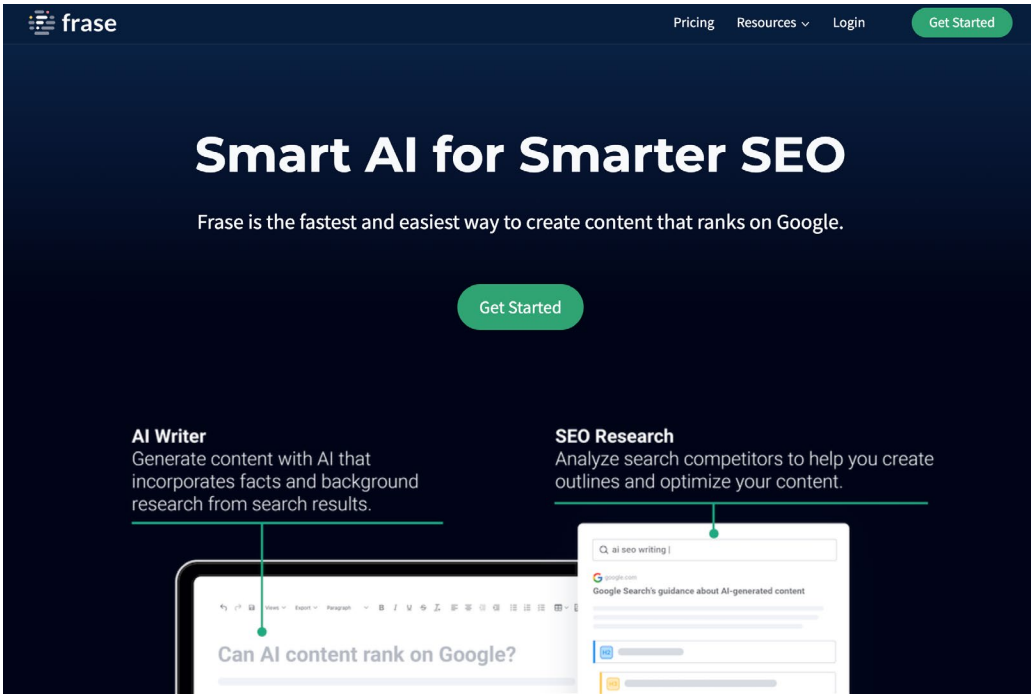
Best features

- SERP research
- AI-powered content briefs
- Content scoring

Pricing

- From $14.99

Frase.io is an AI SEO content optimization tool that can help you create content to rank higher in organic search results. Frase can automatically generate content briefs with outlines and key points.



Frase AI content generator.

3. Robinize

Best for

- Website owners who manage their websites individually
- Startups on a budget

Best features

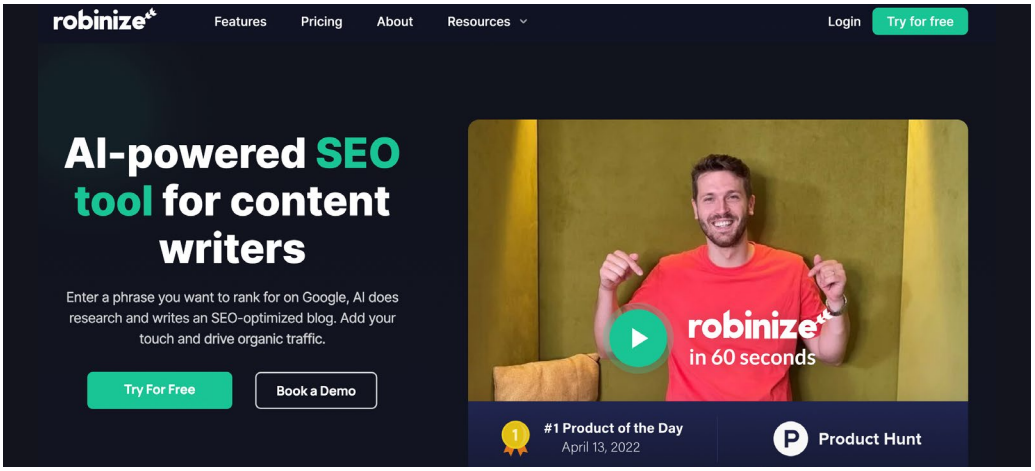
- Outline creation
- SERP analysis
- Keyword highlight

Pricing

- From $19 per month

I have known about Robinize since its first days. I provided feedback about the tool to the owner to improve its functionality.

Even though Robinize is still in its early growth stage, it can help optimize your content for rankings. Moreover, Robinize has a free version with three free monthly reports and a ChatGPT integration. If you want a free or affordable AI SEO tool, you can register and try Robinize here.



Robinize AI SEO tool for content creators and website owners.

4. Koala Writer AI

Best for

- SEO writers
- Website owners

Best features

- Automatic SEO optimization
- Article length selection
- Ability to customize an outline

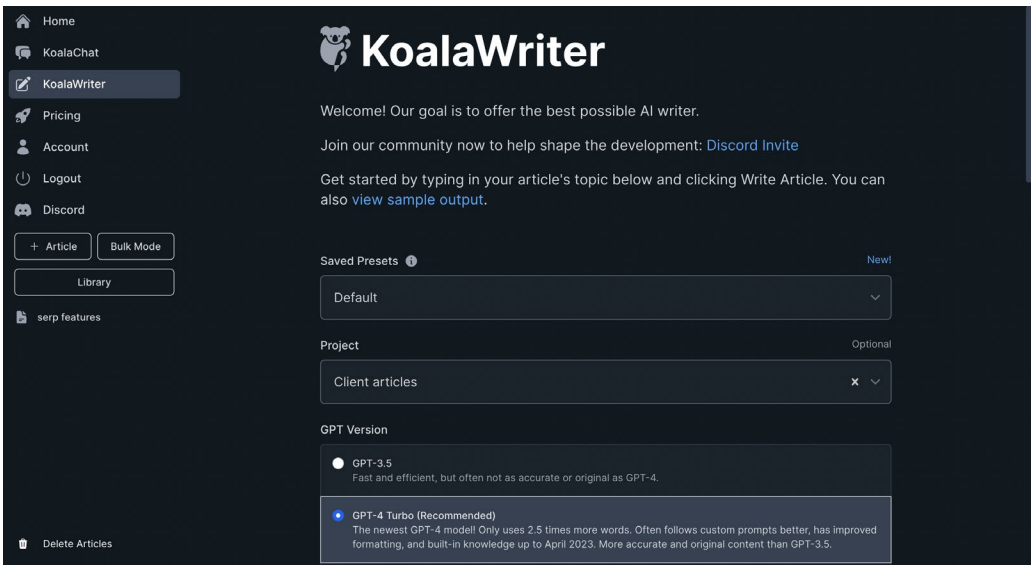
Pricing

- From $9 per month

Koala Writer is an AI-powered writing tool that can help you create high-quality, long-form content quickly and easily. It automatically analyzes the SERP for your keyword and includes entities and keywords to help your articles rank.

For example, with Koala Writer, you can generate ready-to-publish Amazon affiliate articles in minutes and publish them directly to your WordPress blog in one click.

I've started using the Koala paid version to speed up my website and client work. I admit it creates decent content. However, it requires editing anyway.



Koala Writer AI content generator.

5. Mangools

Best for

- Website owners in need of an all-in-one SEO tool
- SEO experts

Best features

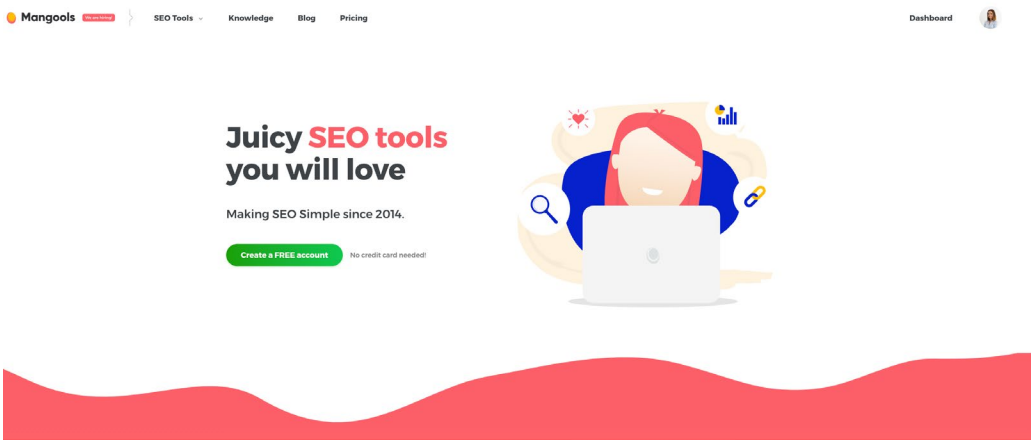
- Keyword research
- Rank tracking

Pricing

- From $29 per month

I stumbled upon Mangools while looking for alternatives to expensive industry giants like Semrush and Ahrefs. Many content creators can't afford to pay $100+ to use these SEO tools. That's why alternatives, like Mangools, exist.

Mangools is a suite of SEO tools that helps you analyze your website's performance, identify new keyword opportunities, track your rankings, and find backlinks. It is an excellent choice for beginner bloggers and professionals alike.



Mangools SEO tool.

6. Ahrefs

Best for

- Startups
- Agencies
- Content writers with multiple clients
- Website owners with established websites

Best features

- Keyword explorer
- Top pages report
- Site audit

Pricing

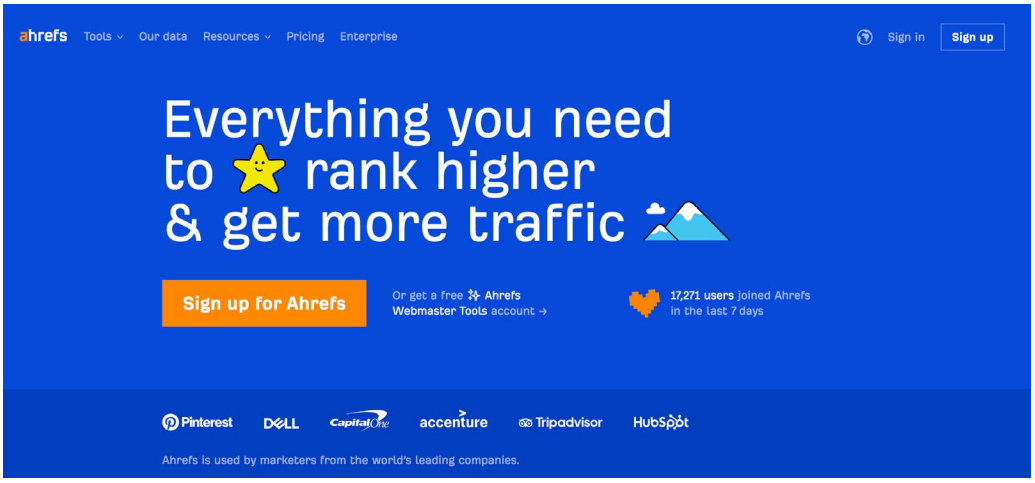
- From $99 per month

It’s the last but definitely not the least important SEO tool on my list.

I was and am a big fan of Ahrefs. It’s an expert SEO tool to conduct keyword research, run SEO audits, and analyze your website performance.

I used Ahrefs to conduct keyword research for my website and grow my website from 0 to 6k monthly followers. It’s a highly efficient and powerful tool.

If you have the budget, I recommend Ahrefs as one of the most accurate SEO tools on the market.



Ahrefs SEO Pro tool.



IN CONCLUSION

You've finished reading the third edition of my SEO ebook updated for 2024.

I packed it with my proven-to-work SEO and content writing strategies that have worked for me and my clients for years.

The fundamentals don't change. Google still favors high-quality content, while SEO specialists still place keywords in meta tags and headers. I don't think it will change any time soon. These strategies will continue working. However, the competition in organic search results will increase, forcing website owners to seek new ways to grow organic traffic.

AI-generated content will take off this year because more and more website owners rely entirely on AI tools for content generation. I often see how SEO experts and niche site owners openly discuss growing their websites with AI on X (former Twitter). It's like playing in the "Who'll publish more articles?" game.

If you want to use AI tools for content generation, do it wisely! Google won't penalize your website if your content satisfies user intent and clearly shows your expertise.

Don't worry about those who publish more content than you and brag about using AI. Your ultimate goal is to grow your website. It's a long journey where consistency and SEO white hat strategies matter more than anything else.

Before planning a website, brainstorm ideas and validate your topics

with keyword research.

Remember, SEO is not a sprint. It is a marathon.

Consistent actions will help you see the first results in at least six months. However, it may take at least one year to see decent results and monetization opportunities.

Luckily, this ebook provides you with bullet-proof strategies on how to start.

Good luck in your future endeavors!

THANK YOU! LET'S CONNECT!



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